

the hindu businessline

bl.portfolio

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

Capex chronicles.
With strong financials, will India Inc deliver on capital spend now?
BIG STORY P4

Index outlook.
Benchmark indices need a trigger for fresh rally and are awaiting breakout
CHART-GAZING P9

Will old adage of ‘dumb money’ return?

MISPLACED BETS. Small investors’ ‘buy-the-deep’ move seems to be backfiring and it may be time to re-orient strategy

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

For much of market history prior to the Covid crash in March 2020, retail money was often termed ‘dumb money’. But as with everything in markets, nothing lasts forever.

Post the crash, retail investors turned the tables and bought aggressively. In fact, globally they made institutions look dumb — the GameStop short squeeze being one among many examples.

But with the prolonged market correction since September 2024, concerns are emerging over whether the old adage is making a comeback.

After the Indian stock market peaked on September 24, 2024, the reward system changed. Stocks began to crumble, market breadth narrowed, and the easy phase of the bull market gave way to a more punishing one.

KEEP BUYING

Yet, individual investors appear to have stuck to the old script — buy more of what has fallen the most.

A *bl.portfolio* analysis of 1,993 NSE-listed companies using Capitaline data show that the deeper the stock’s fall since the September 2024 peak, the more likely individuals were to increase their ownership.

Sample this. Total individual stake rose in about 37 per cent of stocks that were flat or delivered positive returns since

The deeper the stock fall, the more individuals raised their stakes

Stock performance band	No. of stocks	% where total individual stake rose (%)	Median stock change (%)
Gainers / flat	575	37	30.60
Fell 0-20%	357	44	-11.50
Fell 20-40%	482	54	-31.00
Fell 40-60%	421	68	-48.70
Fell more than 60%	158	84	-67.00

Source: Capitaline, bl.portfolio calculations; Stock universe: 1993 NSE-listed stocks; Stock price change measured between Sep. 24, 2024 to Jun. 25, 2026 with adjusted prices

September 2024. But the proportion climbed steadily as losses deepened.

In the 0-20 per cent stock-decline bucket, total individual stake rose in 44 per cent of companies. The figure increased to 54 per cent in the 20-40 per cent decline bucket, climbed to 68 per cent among stocks that fell 40-60 per cent, and exceeded 83 per cent in stocks that corrected by more than 60 per cent.

It is in this last set that price corrections were the deepest. Take Ola Electric. The stock is down around 60 per cent, but total individual stake has surged 215 per cent.

Go Fashion is down nearly 70 per cent, yet individual ownership has jumped a massive 362 per cent.

RETAIL’S BIG DREAMS

While changes in total individual stake capture the combined shareholding of both small retail investors and larger individual/HNI investors, trends among small retail investors (res-

ident individuals holding below ₹2 lakh nominal share capital) reveal the ‘catching falling knives’ syndrome even more starkly.

In the 71 per cent of the universe that has delivered negative returns, small retail investors have increased their holdings in every one of those 1,418 stocks.

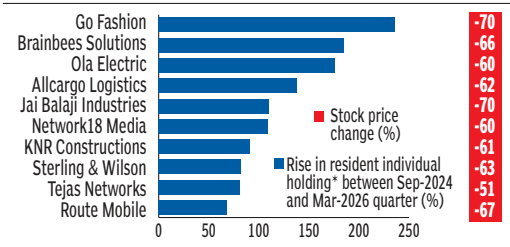
That 100 per cent hit rate is not even the most striking part. In more than 1,000 of those stocks, small retail investors have at least doubled their holdings.

For instance, in Kaynes Technology (down 42 per cent since September 2024), small investors increased their stake by 131 per cent — from 7.8 per cent in the September 2024 quarter to a whopping 18 per cent by March 2026.

In Brainbees Solutions, which itself went public only in 2024, small retail stake has risen 185 per cent.

In fact, across all the 1,418 stocks that have

Stocks that fell atleast 50 per cent and saw biggest rise in retail shareholding



Source: Capitaline, bl.portfolio calculations; * those holding nominal share capital up to ₹2 lakh; Stock price change measured between Sep. 24, 2024 to Jun. 25, 2026 with adjusted prices

fallen since September 2024, small retail investors have increased exposure by at least 30 per cent.

UNHUNGRY INSTITUTIONS

The contrast with institutions is stark. Among stocks that have fallen more than 60 per cent from their September 2024 peaks, total individual stake rose in 83.5 per cent of companies. FIIs raised holdings in only 20.3 per cent, mutual funds in 6.3 per cent and insurers in just 5.1 per cent.

In Allcargo Logistics, individual stake rose 140 per cent even as combined institutional ownership (FIIs, mutual funds and insurers) fell 34 per cent. Sterling & Wilson Renewable Energy showed a similar pattern, with individual stake up 57 per cent and institutional ownership down 52 per cent.

Lower valuations may have supported the buying case in some stocks, but the broader behaviour ap-

pears to have been driven more by price damage than by valuation discipline. Consider high P/E stocks such as Epack Durable (128x), Entero Healthcare (171x) and Easy Trip Planners (441x).

Total individual and small retail holdings have increased even though these stocks have become more expensive on valuation metrics.

The trillion-dollar question is not whether the old needle-hunting instinct of individual investors has survived the market’s turn. It is whether buying fallen stocks will once again be rewarded.

In the current phase, many investors are no longer picking needles from a rising haystack. They are averaging down in a field that has, in its entirety, started to pick.

Individual investors would do well to buy based on fundamentals, valuations and the direction of a company’s business — not merely on how far a stock has fallen from its peak.

Persistent arm to buy Nagarro in \$2.9-billion AI play

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

IT company Persistent Systems’ wholly-owned subsidiary, Galaxy Germany Holding SE, on Saturday announced a voluntary public takeover offer for all outstanding shares of German AI-led digital engineering firm Nagarro, in a deal aimed at creating a \$2.9-billion global AI engineering powerhouse.

The offer follows the signing of a Business Combination Agreement (BCA) between Persistent and Nagarro and envisages a cash consideration of €81 per share.

FUNDING & LISTING

According to Persistent, the offer price represents a premium of 140 per cent to Nagarro’s undisturbed closing price on June 25, 2026, and 94 per cent to its three-month volume-weighted average price.

Persistent will fund the acquisition through committed financing of ₹1.4 billion from Barclays Bank, backed by a corporate guarantee of up to ₹1.54 billion. The company said leverage would remain within conservative limits and is expected to decline meaningfully over the next two years.

Following completion of the transaction, Persistent intends to delist Nagarro shares from the Prime Standard segment of the Frankfurt Stock Exchange, subject to legal and regulat-

ory requirements.

“AI is reshaping our industry at an unprecedented pace. Success will belong to companies that combine deep technical capability with global reach, while continuing to attract, develop and inspire exceptional people,” said Anand Deshpande, Founder, Chairman and Managing Director, Persistent Systems.

“Together, Persistent and Nagarro will be better positioned to help clients navigate this new era, create greater opportunities for our teams and build an organisation that will endure for many years to come,” he added.

AI POWERHOUSE

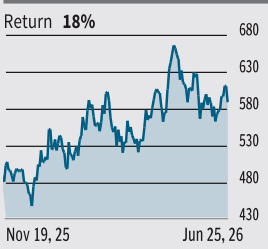
Manas Human, Co-founder and CEO of Nagarro, said the combined entity would be better placed to deliver increasingly complex AI-driven transformation programmes at scale across industries and geographies.

The merged entity will have more than 46,000 employees across over 40 countries, including 37,000 in India, 3,500 in North America and 3,000 in Europe.

Despite the strategic rationale cited by both companies, analysts *businessline* spoke to questioned the rich acquisition premium, noting that Nagarro has been posting only mid-single-digit growth. Some analysts also suggested that investor pressure to deploy excess cash may have influenced the deal.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Tenneco Clean Air India: Accumulate



Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

Investors with a long-term perspective can accumulate the stock of Tenneco Clean Air India (TCAIL) on dips.

TCAIL, which supplies exhaust systems for passenger vehicles (PVs) and commercial vehicles (CVs), stands to gain from the next generation of emission norms, namely, CAFE III (from FY28) and BS-VII (date to be notified) in India and Euro 7 (from November 2026) in the EU. Besides, as a market leader in suspension parts, TCAIL is also a beneficiary of a premiumisation trend occurring in PV suspension systems. Consequently, the order-book has swollen to ₹12,400 crore, lending earnings visibility. This is about 2.3x the FY26 revenue.

The stock trades at around 33x the likely earnings in FY27. In the last two years the company’s earnings have grown at a CAGR of a little over 20 per cent and is likely to remain decent going forward as well. Accumulating on dips offers better margin of safety in the current context.

‘MSMEs must innovate, scale up to build competitive global businesses’

Our Bureau
Coimbatore

Innovation-led growth, technology adoption and stronger regional industrial collaboration emerged as the key themes at the fifth edition of *The Hindu businessline*’s MSME Growth Conclave, co-powered by the Kerala State Industrial Development Corporation (KSIDC) and Central Bank of India, held in Coimbatore on Saturday.

Setting the context, Jairam Varadaraj, Managing Director of ELGI Equipments, in his keynote address, said Indian companies must stop depending on government support and low-cost manufacturing as their primary growth strategy and instead focus on building globally competitive, innovation-led businesses.

He urged companies to move away from ‘Me-too’ products and create ‘Me-First’ products’ by identifying customers’ unstated needs rather than merely responding to existing demand. Businesses, he said, should build capabilities based on ‘know why’ — deep scientific understanding — rather than just ‘know how’, and look beyond India’s relatively small domestic market to tap global opportunities.

THREE CHALLENGES

Ravichandran Purushothaman, Chairman of CII Southern Region and President of Danfoss India, identified three major challenges confronting MSMEs — shortage of skilled manpower, rising electricity costs and uncertainty in order inflows. He called on MSMEs to invest in digital technologies, automation and energy-efficient solutions to improve productivity and operational visibility.



SETTING GROWTH AGENDA. Jairam Varadaraj, MD, ELGI Equipments, speaking at *The Hindu businessline*’s MSME Growth Conclave in Coimbatore on Saturday BUOY GHOSH

Rather than concentrating on asset ownership, entrepreneurs should build businesses around knowledge, IP and scalable business models, which he described as the ‘new money’ that would define future competitiveness. He also stressed the importance of corporate governance, stock market listing and stronger cash generation instead of focussing solely on topline growth, he said in a conversation with Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, *businessline*.

KERALA CALLING

Making a pitch for Kerala as an investment destination, Arun K Vijayan, Director of Industries and Managing Director of KSIDC, said the State was positioning itself as the next major manufacturing hub through the proposed Integrated Manufacturing Cluster at Palakkad. The panel on ‘Financing in the time of war’, pointed to the difficulties faced by a large number

of micro and small industries in accessing finance due to lack of awareness and bureaucratic hurdles.

AN OPPORTUNITY

In the panel discussion on clean mobility, the panelists said that clean mobility was more an opportunity than a threat. Since vehicle owning itself is yet to cover much of India’s opportunity, there is a big market emerging for e-vehicles and therefore for MSMEs.

The Associate Partners of the event were Bank of Baroda, Tally Solutions, SSVM Institutions, Indian Overseas Bank, Salzer Electronics Limited, South Indian Bank, Turbo Engineers, Zorian Systems, Suguna Pumps & Motors, Malles Construction, eRockey Motors India, and Ruh Continuum School.

The Realty Partner is G Square and Lifestyle Partner is Lexus.

Full coverage p2,p3

Strides Pharma sells majority stake in arm Pivot Path for ₹100 cr

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Strides Pharma Science Ltd on Saturday announced divestment of majority stake in its wholly-owned arm Pivot Path for ₹100 crore to a consortium of investors led by Ascent Capital, along with co-investor Vintage.

The board of directors, at its meeting held on June 27, approved the strategic investment.

The transaction entails Strides selling a majority stake in Pivot Path to Ascent Capital and Vintage Classic for ₹100 crore, alongside a ₹50-crore primary infusion by Ascent Capital to support the company’s next growth phase.

Strides will receive ₹75 crore at the initial closing and ₹25 crore a year later. Post-transaction, Strides will retain a 19.95 per cent stake, while investors will hold 65.05 per cent and the ESOP pool 15 per cent, the filing said.

Working on a Trump visit to India early next year: Marco Rubio

Reuters

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Washington is seeking to arrange a visit to India by President Donald Trump early next year as the countries work on a bilateral trade deal, media outlet IANS reported on Saturday.

Rubio is likely to travel to India this year to prepare for the President’s visit, he said. “We’re working towards some time early next year to have the President come,” Rubio said.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Trump last week on the sidelines of a Group Seven summit in France. Trump said that they had a “very good” conversation.

CITY UNION BANK

*With Deep Admiration,
We Congratulate*

Prof. V. KAMAKOTI
Non-Executive Independent Director, City Union Bank
Director, Indian Institute of Technology, Madras

PADMA SHRI
Awardee - 2026

*We take pride in our association with your
remarkable journey of excellence and innovation.*

The Chairman, MD & CEO, Board of Directors and Staff of
CITY UNION BANK

122+ YEARS
TRUST & EXCELLENCE

1000+
BRANCHES

22+ STATES
PRESENCE

www.cityunionbank.bank.in

‘MSMEs must break out of the small comfort zone and grow’

BIGGER ROLE. Must shift focus to building larger, purpose-driven enterprises: Elgi Equipments MD

M Ramesh
Coimbatore

Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) should not aspire to remain small forever. Once they achieve stable profitability, they must shift their focus from merely making money to building larger, purpose-driven enterprises, said Jairam Varadaraj, Managing Director of Elgi Equipments.

Further, MSMEs must grow from producers of “me-too” products to creating “I first” products, he said, speaking at the 5th MSME Growth Conclave, organised by *The Hindu businessline*, in Coimbatore on Saturday.

Varadaraj argued that remaining an MSME should be viewed as a starting point, rather than a destination.

“There is a lot of seduction to remain small,” he said, referring to the tendency of businesses to avoid regulatory scrutiny or preserve complete ownership. “Small is a good starting point. It is not a good state. MSMEs have to stop becoming MSMEs at some point. They’ve got to grow.”

He said entrepreneurs often fear losing control as their companies expand, or hesitate to dilute ownership. But these concerns, he said, should not stand in the way of creating larger, more valuable businesses. “I would rather own 5 per cent of a company worth billions of dollars than 100 per cent of a company worth a few million dollars,” he remarked.

GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

Varadaraj also challenged the conventional belief that government support is indispensable for business growth. While policy support is welcome, companies should develop the capability to succeed despite policy



SUCCESS STORY. Jairam Varadaraj, MD of Elgi Equipments (left), being presented a memento by Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, *businessline*, at the MSME conclave in Coimbatore on Saturday PHOTOS BY BUJOY GHOSH



ate “I first” products — innovations that are the first of their kind.

He illustrated the point with examples such as Apple’s touchscreen smartphone, which addressed an unstated customer need that users themselves had not articulated, and the introduction of shampoo sachets in India, which solved consumers’ cashflow constraints, rather than reducing the price of shampoo.

“The tyranny of cheap labour should only be a window, not a permanent strategy,” he said. “We cannot build a country on the back of Indians being cheap.”

According to Varadaraj, sustained growth also requires

hurdles, rather than depend on government incentives.

Another mindset that needs to change, he said, is India’s reliance on low-cost manufacturing and “me-too” products. Instead, businesses should strive to cre-

Entrepreneurs often fear losing control as their companies expand, or hesitate to dilute ownership. But these concerns should not stand in the way of creating larger, more valuable businesses, said Jairam Varadaraj

companies to move beyond profit as their sole objective.

Once a business reaches a stable level of profitability, it must scale with a broader purpose that balances the interests of employees, suppliers, investors and society.

“If profit remains the only driver, you will not scale,” he said.

BUILDING CREDIBILITY

He also stressed the importance of strong governance and regulatory compliance, calling them investments, rather than costs. High standards of governance build credibility with investors and lenders, making it easier for companies to raise capital and pursue long-term growth.

He gave the example of his own company, whose share prices are ruling at around 45 times its earnings. He said the high PE showed the faith investors had in the numbers the company published.

NATION’S AMBITION

India’s ambition of becoming a developed nation, he added, will depend not only on higher GDP, but also on building innovative, globally competitive businesses that create value for all stakeholders

Despite govt initiatives, ‘lack of awareness hindering MSMEs’ access to financing’



(from left to right) Karthikeyan Mounaguruswamy, Immediate Past President, CODISSIA; Rahul Jyothi Kumaran, Head- SME Business, Sundaram Finance; Kumar Duraiswamy, CEO, Eastern Global Clothing, and Joint Secretary, Tiruppur Exporters’ Association, join Lokeshwarri SK, Moderator and Data Editor, *businessline*, for a panel session on Financing in Times of War at the MSME conclave

Our Bureau
Coimbatore

Micro, small and medium companies (MSMEs) face challenges that are dichotomous. Working capital at competitive rates is hard to come by, and where available, poor awareness and reluctance to engage with multiple stakeholders prevent engagement.

This came to the fore at a discussion on *Financing in Times of War*, moderated by *businessline*’s Data Editor Lokeshwarri SK, panellists included Karthikeyan Mounaguruswamy, Immediate Past President, Codissia; Kumar Duraiswamy, CEO, Eastern Global Clothing and Joint Secretary, Tiruppur Exporters’ Association; and Rahul Jyothi Kumaran, Head of SME Business, Sundaram Finance.

Mounaguruswamy said that a majority of loans taken by micro units — up to 60 per cent — is still based on gold jewellery as collateral, which can turn out to be expensive even in the medium-term. “Businesses prefer jewellery loans as they are a safer bet. But, over the long term, only the banking sector can support MSMEs on growth.”

ECLGS SCHEME

On the ECLGS scheme, Kumar Duraiswamy said: “We have to give great credit to the Centre for the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme. But, in South India, especially the Kongu region, communication has not been adequate. A PSB banker told me that in this region, about 2,400 MSMEs are eligible for this facility. Of this, they had received 400 applications, all of which had been sanctioned, but only 225 units have taken up the loans.”

He pointed to the lack of adequate orders that

makes repayment difficult. “I need orders to run my factory. This supply chain disruption [due to the West Asia war] will take a full year at least to return to normal. Other supplying nations are more competitive than we are.”

TAKING ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

Asked if the bond market or equity market is a realistic alternative route to funding, Duraiswamy said: “These are Greek and Latin to many of our members. We need to be educated about it. Even top firms, doing more than ₹500 crore in revenue, are reluctant to go down this road.”

On the idea of cashflow data being used to avail of credit, Kumaran said: “This is an idea whose time has come. Such schemes can be created by banks and NBFCs under the existing framework. Aggravating the problem of funding for MSMEs is large companies not showing urgency in clearing dues.”

“The largest banker to large companies has been the MSME sector,” said Kumaran. “There has been a 22-45-day increase in working capital cycles recently. MSMEs are not in a position to reject business either.”

UNPAID DUES

Mounaguruswamy pointed out that the TReDS (Trade Receivables electronic Discounting System) is not being used adequately by MSMEs. Bankers who are part of the TReDS system have highlighted the fact that a significant quantum of dues remained unpaid as the bills had not been uploaded in a proper way, despite being more than 45 days overdue.

“About ₹10-lakh crore MSME funds are being held by PSUs.” He added that as the funding squeeze gets tighter, MSMEs may have no option but use the TReDS platform.

+ Danfoss India President says ‘make new money, not old money’

Our Bureau
Coimbatore

“It’s all about new money for MSMEs today.” Ravichandran Purushothaman, Chairman of CII Southern Region, and President of Danfoss India’s advise to the emerging and existing entrepreneurs to “make the new money, not the old money”, generated a quick response from an engrossed audience at *The Hindu businessline* MSME conclave.

He urged MSMEs not to focus on the top line, but on profit margins and cash flows and to pivot towards new technology, innovation, intellectual property and scalable business models, rather than accumulating physical assets. Purushothaman said leadership, mindset and the ability to create value through knowledge would determine whether India’s MSMEs could drive the country’s ambition of becoming a \$30-trillion economy.

In the fireside chat with *businessline* Resident Editor Richa Mishra, focussing on the rising cost of business for MSMEs due to the West Asia war, Purushothaman said the crisis has exposed vulnerabilities in global supply chains, but also

opened new opportunities for Indian MSMEs to diversify markets, strengthen resilience and adopt new technologies.

He highlighted that despite the challenges, India’s exports had performed well over the past three months, helped by the close collaboration between industry and the government, although supply chain disruptions would take time to normalise. The crisis had prompted companies to re-examine their entire value chains, including lower-tier suppliers, and identify new logistics routes.

Several MSMEs had started using the deepwater port at Vizhinjam in Kerala and explored alternative transshipment hubs, such as Thailand, Singapore and Colombo, to reduce dependence on traditional routes.

RISE IN LOGISTICS COSTS

The experience underscored the need to diversify both supplier and customer bases and build resilient businesses capable of withstanding future disruptions, Purushothaman said. Responding to concerns over rising logistics costs, particularly for MSMEs, Purushothaman said there was no one-size-fits-all solution.

While Danfoss had passed on some price increases, it had also absorbed costs in other cases to preserve long-term supplier relationships spanning decades. Government measures such as additional credit support and faster customs clearances had helped, but companies would ultimately need to find sustainable ways to manage costs and strengthen their supply chains, he added.

THREE KEY ISSUES

On the challenges facing MSMEs, he identified three key issues — availability of skilled manpower, rising electricity costs and uncertainty in order inflows. He urged MSMEs to invest in digital technologies, automation and energy-efficient solutions to improve productivity and operational visibility.

Purushothaman also stressed the importance of corporate governance, listing on stock exchanges and improving cash generation, instead of chasing topline growth alone. He expressed concerns over the migration of engineering talent from Tamil Nadu, and said the State would need greater automation and vocational training to address demographic changes and labour shortages.

Highlighting emerging opportunities, he said more MSMEs were entering sectors such as defence, electronics and electric mobility. India must move deeper into high-value manufacturing, including sensors, electronics and component ecosystems, instead of remaining focused on traditional metal-based manufacturing.

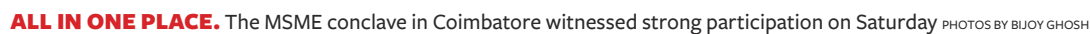
He cited Coimbatore’s pump industry and Mysuru’s defence manufacturing ecosystem as examples of clusters that could evolve into globally competitive hubs by building specialised capabilities and stronger brands.



UNDIVIDED ATTENTION. Attendees pose questions to the panelists while others are engaged in a discussion at the conclave



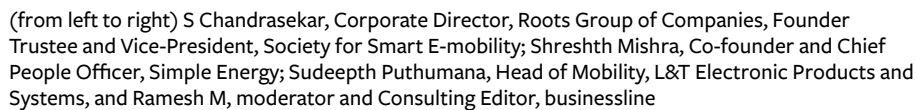
POINTS TO PONDER. Ravichandran Purushothaman, Chairman of CII Southern Region, and President of Danfoss India, in a fireside chat with Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, *businessline*



‘Moving up value chain key for MSMEs to capture clean mobility opportunity’

Our Bureau
Coimbatore

The executives were speaking at a panel discussion on *The Clean Mobility Opportunity* for MSMEs, moderated by Ramesh M, Resident Editor, *businessline*. S Chandrasekar, Corporate Director, Roots Group of Companies, Founder Trustee and Vice-President, Society for Smart E-mobility, said that EVs offer both an

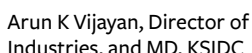


increase their R&D investment and the development of proprietary technologies in niche products and specialised components.

Shreshth Mishra, Co-founder and Chief People Officer, Simple Energy, said that the company works with

Sudeepth Puthumana, Head of Mobility, L&T Electronic Products and Systems, noted that building domestic ecosystems for EVs is especially critical since Indian automakers still rely heavily on global supply chains for components. "Many Indian start-ups have shown that local supply chains can be built around Indian requirements. MSMEs similarly need to participate in technologies that are traditionally sourced from global players," he said.

Our Bureau
Coimbatore

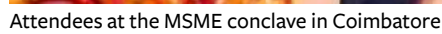


“For Tamil Nadu MSMEs looking for the next chapter of growth, Kerala is not a distant option. Kerala is the natural gateway on the western frontier,” he said, adding that Kerala sits at the intersection of logistics,

"The border exists on the map, but the economy has always worked as one corridor," he said, describing the relationship as a "Tamil Nadu plus Kerala

The project involves a capital investment of ₹3,806 crore, and is expected to unlock investments of ₹8,729 crore.

Inviting entrepreneurs to expand in Kerala, Vijayan said, "Kerala is rising. Please rise with us so that entire South India can rise together".





THE HINDU GROUP

A Special Publication from

thehindu **businessline**

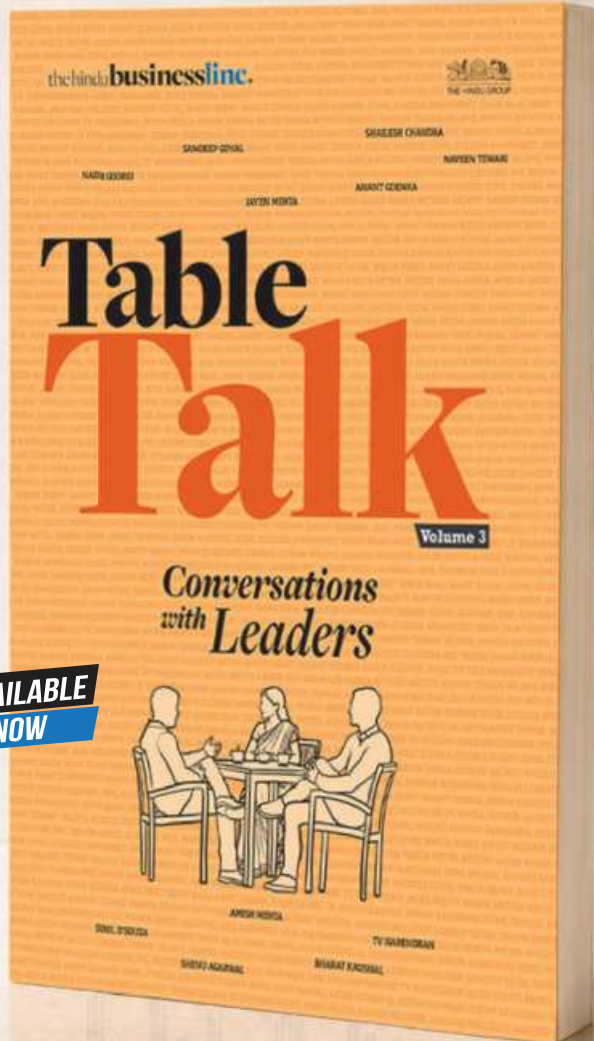
The third volume in our Table Talk series brings you fascinating insights on the personalities of business leaders and how they run their companies

LAUNCH OFFER

25% OFF*

COVER PRICE
₹400*

AVAILABLE NOW





TO AVAIL THIS LIMITED PERIOD OFFER,
SCAN QR CODE OR VISIT

newsth.live/THBookStore



For bulk booking and enquiries, contact us at bookstore@thehindu.co.in

* shipping charges applicable | Terms and Conditions apply

 **K.P.R. MILL LIMITED**
CIN: L17111T22003PLC010518
Registered Office: No.9, Gokul Buildings, 1st Floor,
A.K.S. Nagar, Thadagam Road, Coimbatore-641001
Phone: 0422-2207777
Website: www.kprmilllimited.com **E-mail ID:** corporate@kprmill.com

Notice for Transfer of Shares to IEFP

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to Companies Act, 2013 and the Investors Education and Protection Fund (IEPF) Rules, 2016 all undaimed Final Dividend 2018-19 for the last 7 years as on12.06.2026 and the underlying Equity shares of the Shareholders who have not claimed Dividend for 7 consecutive years will be transferred to the IEFP on 29.09.2026.The Company has communicated individually to the concerned shareholders and the details of such shareholder and shares are also made available on our above website as per the aforesaid Rules. In case no communication is received from the concerned shareholders on or before 28.09.2026, the Company shall transfer the shares to IEFP Authority without any further notice to the Shareholders. To claim those shares, the procedure prescribed under IEFP Rules have to be followed. For any queries on the above, shareholder may contact the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agents/Ms. NSDL Database Management Limited, Mumbai. Phone number - 022-49142589, Email ID: sunilk@ndml.in.

For K.P.R. Mill Limited
Sd/-
P.Kandaswamy
Company Secretary

Coimbatore
27.06.2026



THE HINDU GROUP

Share your feedback on bl.portfolio



Whatsapp on: 73583 71111



Scan the code



TANLA PLATFORMS LIMITED
CIN: LT2200TG1995PLC021262, Registered Office: Tanla Technology Centre,
 Hitec City Road, Hyderabad - 500 081
 Phone: +91 040 00099999, Fax No.: +91 040 2312 2999
 E-mail: investorhelp@tanla.com, Website: www.tanla.com

**NOTICE OF 30TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING,
 INTIMATION OF CUT-OFF DATE AND E-VOTING INFORMATION**

Notice is hereby given that the 30th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of Tanla Platforms Limited (the "Company") will be held on Monday, July 20, 2026, at 04:00 P M IST through Video Conferencing/Other Audio-Visual Means, to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of the said Annual General Meeting.

In compliance with General Circular No. 3/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and the Circulars issued from time to time by Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) (hereinafter collectively referred to as "the Circulars"), Companies are allowed to hold AGM through VC, without the physical presence of Shareholders at a common venue. Hence, the AGM of the Company is being held through VC to transact the business as set forth in the Notice of the AGM dated June 23, 2026.

The Company has appointed KFin Technologies Limited (Kfintech), to provide VC/OAVM facility for the AGM and the attendant enablers for conducting the AGM.

Electronic copy of the Integrated Annual Report including the Notice of 30th AGM of the Company has been sent to the members on Saturday, June 27, 2026 on the e-mail IDs registered with the Company / Depository Participant(s) for communication purposes. The Notice of the AGM along with Integrated Annual Report is being sent only by electronic mode to those members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/Depositories in accordance with the above-mentioned Circulars. The Integrated Annual Report including Notice is available on the website of the Company www.tanla.com; website of the stock exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively and on website of Kfintech i.e. <https://evoting.kfintech.com>.

In compliance with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 the Company is pleased to provide its Shareholders with facility of "remote e-voting" (e-voting from a place other than venue of the AGM), through E-Voting Services provided by Kfintech, to enable them to cast their votes on the resolutions set out in the Notice.

In accordance with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, the Company has fixed Monday, July 13, 2026 as the "Cut-off date" to determine the eligibility to vote by electronic means. A person whose name is recorded in the register of members, maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date i.e. Monday, July 13, 2026, shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting.

The remote e-voting period begins on Friday, July 17, 2026 (9:00 a.m. IST) and ends on Sunday, July 19, 2026 (5:00 p.m. IST). During this period the eligible shareholders of the Company, holding shares either in physical form or in dematerialized form, may cast their vote electronically. The e-voting module shall be disabled by Kfintech for voting thereafter.

Those persons who have acquired shares and have become members of the Company after the e-dispatch of Notice of the AGM by the Company and whose names appear in the Register of Members as on the cut-off date i.e. Monday, July 13, 2026 can also view the Notice of 30th AGM on the Company's website or on the website of Kfintech. Such members can exercise their voting rights through remote e-voting by following the procedure as mentioned in the Notice of AGM under "How do I vote electronically using KFin e-Voting system?", or by voting at the AGM.

Mr. Mahadev Tirunagari, Company Secretary in Practice (CP No. 7350), has been appointed as a Scrutinizer to scrutinize the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

In case of any query and / or assistance required, relating to attending the Meeting through VC / OAVM mode, members may refer to the Help & Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and "AGM VC / OAVM" user manual available at the download Section of <https://evoting.kfintech.com> or contact Mr. Ganesh Chandra Patro, Assistant Vice President, Kfintech at the email ID evoting@kfintech.com on Kfin's toll free No.: 1-800-309-4001 for any further clarifications / technical assistance that may be required.

For Tanla Platforms Limited
 Sd/-
 Seshanuradha Chava
 Company Secretary - M. No. A15519

Date: 27 June, 2026
 Place: Hyderabad

bl.portfolio

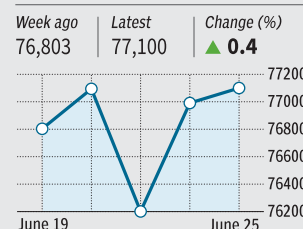
WISE WORDS.

“Sensible value-based investors will always sell too early in bubbles and buy too early in busts. But in return, you may make some important extra money on the roundtrip as well as lowering the average risk exposure

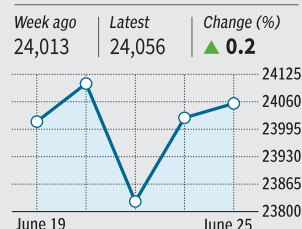
JEREMY GRANTHAM
Market Veteran

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

For India Inc., the business outlook for the near term remains mixed. The early months of the previous fiscal year (FY26) were clouded by tariff-related uncertainty, while the last quarter of FY26 was marked by the US-Iran conflict, which raised fears of a commodity price surge and softer demand. As FY27 begins, tariff concerns have eased somewhat, helped by a series of parallel trade agreements, while the long-awaited India-US deal remains perpetually at the finish line. Meanwhile, the ceasefire between the US and Iran, though still recent, has already led to a sharp decline in oil prices. While this is good news for now, geopolitical uncertainties remain elevated.

Against this backdrop, we examine the capital investment appetite of India Inc. Needless to say, future growth depends on today's investments. In recent years, there has been hope for revival in private capex many times, but so far this inflexion point has remained elusive. Can similar hope materialise this time around?

Based on our analysis, most financial indicators point to both the need for and the capacity to support a renewed investment cycle. The point being, without more investments from here, higher growth rate in revenue and profit may not be forthcoming for India Inc as a whole. We also assess emerging investment trends across sectors and companies.

For this analysis, we have considered 1,002 companies which have reported data for the last 10 years, from FY17 to FY26. We have excluded BFSI and IT sectors from the list.

GROWTH AFTER A LULL

The fixed asset base for all the companies grew at 9 per cent CAGR in FY17-26. Fixed assets refer to all tangible assets including capital works in progress. But fixed asset growth comes in waves and as shown in the figure, ranges from 0 to 20 per cent year on year. The lowest growth was recorded in FY21, the year of the pandemic. This flat growth was preceded by a period of high capital addition at 11 per cent CAGR in FY17-20. The graph shows that a similar circumstance has developed currently as well. Although not comparable to the Covid impact on economy, trade tariffs and geopolitical uncertainty were at the highest in FY26, which recorded the second lowest growth at 4 per cent for fixed assets. Also, FY22-25 reported a 11 per cent CAGR growth in fixed assets. Similar to FY21, the last fiscal reported weak capital addition following a period of high growth indicating that a period of strong fixed asset addition is due.

But it is also pertinent to note significant difference between the two periods. Post FY20/21, interest rates were lowered to spur growth alongside high government spending, which was a conducive environment for demand and capital addition. In FY27, interest rates may increase and may influence capex decisions.

PUSH AND PULL FOR CAPACITY EXPANSION

Sales growth, on the other hand, has outperformed asset growth, which raises the question: Can further sales growth be supported without capacity addition. Net sales growth for the companies was at 10 per cent CAGR in FY17-26, and 14.6 per cent CAGR in the post-Covid period of FY21-26. Consequently, the asset turnover ratio (Net Sales/Fixed assets) is now approaching its peak for India Inc, as shown in the graph. This ratio basically captures how much revenue a company is generating by utilising its fixed assets. The ratio in the last decade has been range bound, as high sales growth leads to high-capacity utilisation and, in turn, drives a capacity expansion phase to support further growth, lowering the sales to asset ratio. As the graph indicates, at 1.65 times in FY26, the asset turnover ratio is approaching its peak (utilisation), if not the highest at 1.75 times in FY23.

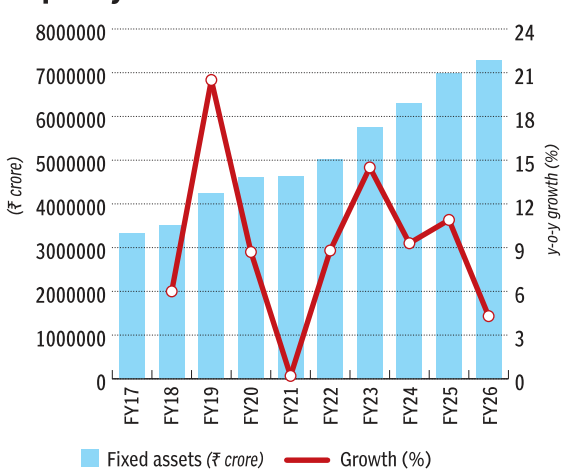
While sales growth is a push factor for capacity addition, margins and return ratios are a pull factor. In periods of high returns, companies and industries are incentivised to expand production to capture the upside. In the current environment, EBITDA margins, PAT margins and RoE are certainly above average and near decade-highs, as shown in the graph. Modest raw material inflation, demand growth, effect of operating leverage, lower financial cost, and

India Inc and its CAPEX chronicles

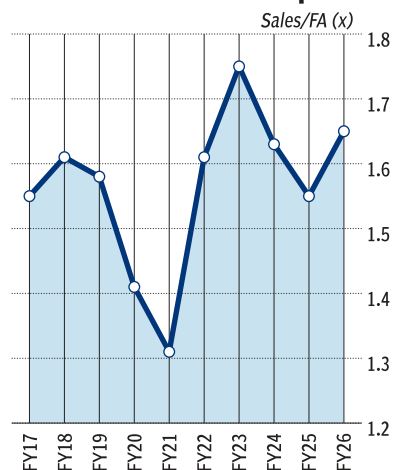
SOWING THE SEED. Tomorrow's growth depends on today's investments. Corporate balance sheets are in pristine shape and asset turnover ratio is nearing a peak. Will India Inc deliver on capex now?

How India Inc. scores on key metrics

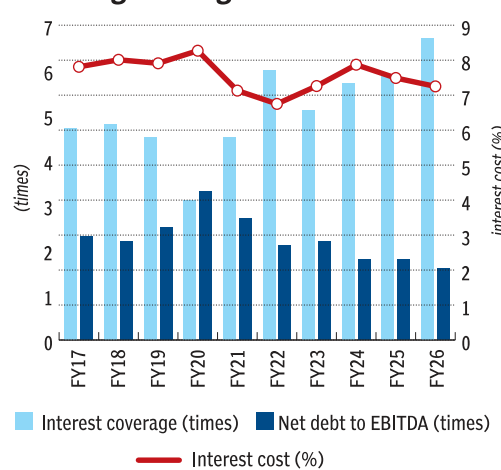
Capex cycle needs to restart



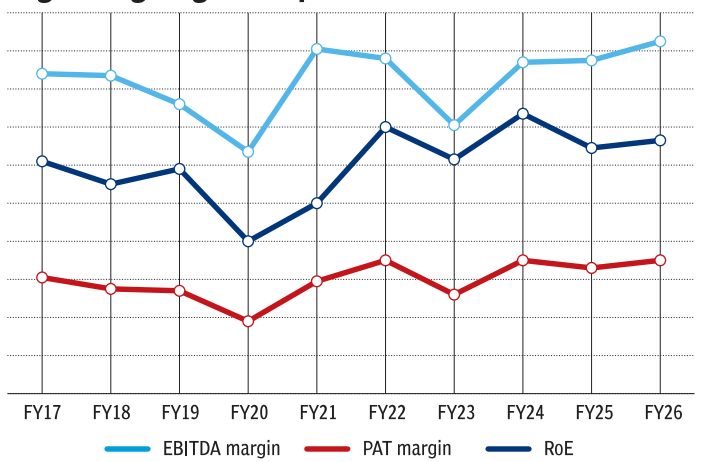
Asset utilisation near peak



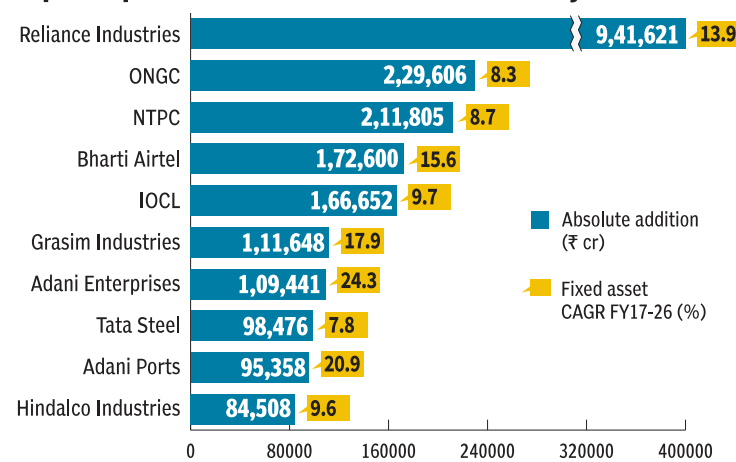
Strong leverage metrics



High margins give scope for reinvestment



Top companies in asset addition in last 10 years



positive policy framework — including high government spending, lowering of income-tax and GST, interest rate cuts — have supported the strong financial performance in the last year despite the overhang of tariffs and wars. While PAT and RoE benefited from corporate tax cuts in FY20, EBITDA margin captures the pure operational performance without such impacts.

While margins will be under pressure from rising commodity costs in the short term, ambitious companies will likely focus on post-conflict recovery and scope for higher returns in the future, especially with more hope for a resolution in US-Iran war.

BALANCE-SHEET STRENGTH

India Inc's balance-sheet strength is at the highest currently. As seen in the graph, interest coverage (EBIT/Interest - measures the profit before interest payments available for interest payments, with a higher number indicating a high ability to service debt) has been continually rising and net Debt to EBITDA (lower the better, indicating the years to clear debt with given EBITDA) has been continually declining, and are simultaneously at the most favourable position now compared to the last decade. While the cost of debt has declined in FY26, as lower interest rates

have been passed on, interest rate hikes and their pass through are expected in FY27.

Balance-sheet strength has been improving post Covid. Investors will increasingly expect companies to leverage their strong balance sheets to add productive assets and generate higher returns.

While short-term volatility and raw material costs are high, companies must focus on innovation and long-term growth opportunities and add to capacities. Investors must look for opportunities in such companies — those that have strong balance sheets and showing willingness to invest, as these are best positioned to benefit when the tide turns positively. For example, companies that invested in advance and had higher capacities capitalised from the boom in steel business during FY21 and FY22.

COMPANY OUTLOOK ON CAPEX

Among companies and sectors, the outlook for capex addition is largely optimistic across many sectors, while there are pockets where some of the leading spenders, like automobiles and infrastructure segments, may see moderation. New-age capacity building is taking shape. This includes several fields of energy — renewables, energy storage, technology — AI/data

centres, indigenous defence and transportation.

We have outlined the capex outlook of a few leading companies, including Reliance Industries, which accounts for a fifth of the asset base in the listed space in FY26.

Reliance is likely to continue with its investment plan in FY27 after investing ₹1.4 lakh crore in FY26. The FY27 expansion will also include New Energy segment (solar modules, solar cell and batteries) and AI/Data Centre operations. The company expects to deliver the addition by keeping leverage within comfortable levels with targeted Net Debt to EBITDA at 1.7-1.8x in FY27 by funding it largely from internal accruals. The refining margins of refineries are expected to stay high despite the war approaching a ceasefire in West Asia. This will be a strong support to the capex plans of refineries, which do not have significant retail fuel marketing operations like Reliance. The other refineries, which are mostly PSU entities, are targeting to achieve net zero emissions by 2040-46. A tall order for many OMC refineries, given their excessive carbon footprint inherent to operations.

Overall, their surpluses will be invested in renewables and EV infrastructure, as was mentioned by IOCL.

Power generation and transmis-

sion are midway to near doubling of power capacity by 2030, with close to 500 GW from renewables. This implies a continued capex spending by the sector. NTPC outlined a capex plan of ₹6.2 lakh crore for the next five years, half of which is allocated towards renewables and a nuclear source. In transmission, Power Grid is also continuing with its capex plan, although a touch smaller than last year (₹37,000 crore in FY27 vs ₹40,000 crore last year). Pumped storage plants, which address the volatility of renewable power, are also being developed by Adani Green, Tata Power. Capital goods players like GE Vernova T&D, Hitachi Energy India will be beneficiaries of this.

The automobile industry has been on a cyclical high with further impetus from GST revision, which should sustain sales momentum in the next one year. Also, with CAFÉ-3 norms coming in place from FY28, it is imperative to add EV/hybrid capacity to satisfy the guidelines. These reasons will sustain the capex phase. But considering the late stage of the upcycle, the industry capex plans are likely to be moderate. The auto ancillary segment is also expected to increase capex with an eye on expansion into EV/hybrid segments.

Steel capex outlook is mixed. JSW Steel is still on a high capex phase — ₹1.3 lakh crore for the next five years

(₹20,000-25,000 crore per year), and so is Tata Steel (₹20,000 crore in FY27). Jindal Steel will focus on efficiency after completing its expansion stage.

Steel demand in India, tied to GDP growth, is expected to be high. Steel prices are under the protection of safeguard duties for the next three years. But the advantage of benign raw material prices may be reversing, at a gradual pace for the industry.

Similarly, capacity addition in cement is also mixed. While UltraTech, the leader, has increased capacity to 200 mtpa now (from 65 mtpa in FY16) and expects to grow to 240 mtpa in the next two years, Ambuja and even Shree Cements, to an extent, are more focused on improving operational efficiency, cost optimisation and improving utilisation rates. While the latter two are also expanding, the enthusiastic growth outlook seems to be tapering off.

In other segments, Hotels and Hospitals are notable. Hospital growth has primarily been relying on volume growth from expanded hospitals in tier-I to -III locations. This is likely to continue across the spectrum from large-cap to small- and mid-cap institutions. The listed hotel companies were already in expansion mode, and that stance is likely to continue. Among the prominent ones, IHCL and ITC Hotels remain more asset-light (management-contract oriented) and pipeline-led, while EIH remains more selective and luxury-focused. Financially, the hotel sector is in a much better position than in the pre-Covid/Covid years, with stronger cash flows and generally-manageable balance sheets. The focus is likely to shift to optimal asset utilisation and return metrics.

The picture is clear: Traditional sectors remain willing participants in the capex cycle, though with a sharper eye on sweating existing assets and improving utilisation. The real momentum, however, is increasingly felt in new-age investment themes—across power, conglomerates and the automobile value chain.

TAKEAWAY

As mentioned above, for investors, the opportunities lie in companies that have strong balance sheets/leverage ratios and are showing willingness to invest. While they may be impacted by temporary downcycles, in the long term they are better positioned to capture the India growth story.

Cement and steel companies that benefited from the upcycle in FY21 and FY22 are good examples. The counter examples are the IT services companies that hardly invested in new growth engines over the previous decade and are facing the brunt of a downcycle in their core business today.

The long term growth of stocks depends on today's investments that companies are making within acceptable leverage metrics, is an important factor that investors must consider.

The tax-filing trilemma: Choosing between self, practitioner or CA

DE-TAX. For salaried employees, small proprietors and small businessmen, the choice of filing should depend on the nature of income — not the size of the tax bill

CA Desikan Govindarajan

The income-tax filing season for FY2025-26 is here. For salaried employees, small proprietor and small businessmen, the question of who should file the return — self, tax practitioner or chartered accountant (CA) — is a more delicate decision than it appears. The right answer depends not on the size of income but its nature, and whether the taxpayer faces any of the recurring complexities that point clearly to professional help.

So, should you file on your own or turn to a professional? Read on to find out.

PRE-FILING — GATHERING AND DECIDING

Before a single digit goes into the return, documents must be colated — Form 26AS and AIS/TIS from the portal, Form 16 from the employer, broker capital gains statements, bank interest certificates and HRA rent receipts. A salaried individual with one employer and modest bank deposits can complete this in under an hour; trouble begins where multiple income streams converge.

A tax practitioner — accountants, advocates and registered TRPs (tax return preparer) — typically receives documents and consolidates them. Advice is limited, data is taken, rates applied, return submitted.

A chartered accountant brings two things the portal cannot:

knowledge of the taxpayer's history, and the discipline of reconciliation.

At the start of the year, when the employer asks the employee to opt for a regime, the CA compares last year's actual outgo under the two regimes and advises the more beneficial choice for the year ahead. At the time of filing, the CA reconciles every reported income against the AIS, since any mismatch now can trigger an automated intimation under Section 143(1) (a document notifying the taxpayer whether the return was accepted, resulted in a refund, or requires additional tax payment), frequently with demand.

FILING — FORM, COMPUTATION, VERIFICATION

On the portal, the self-filer chooses the correct ITR form, populates the schedules, computes tax and e-verifies through Aadhaar OTP, EVC or DSC. The portal's pre-fill removes much of the manual burden. However, several components — many capital gains transactions, foreign income and arrears spread under Section 89 — still need manual entry, and accuracy resting squarely on the filer.

Simple data-entry mistakes are also common in self-filing. Showing an item under the wrong head — say, professional receipts as 'other sources' instead of 'business income' — can trigger a tax demand at intimation, requiring

rectification (under Section 154) or a revised return (under Section 139(5)). For ITR-1, the process is straightforward; for ITR-2 or ITR-3, errors at this stage are among the most common causes of Section 143(1) intimations. The practitioner adds procedural value through tax-return software; the CA adds working-paper retention — a valuable cushion when a query arises later.

WHERE COMPLEXITY DEMANDS A CA

Six recurring situations take a salaried or small-business taxpayer beyond what the portal or a practitioner can comfortably handle.

Reconciling income beyond AIS and 26AS: AIS and Form 26AS are useful, but not complete. Cash receipts, rental flows, savings bank interest (when below the reporting threshold) and capital gains across multiple brokers often need cross-checking against bank statements before the true income picture emerges. A CA reconciles these sources line by line, sharply reducing the risk of a later intimation.

Arrears of salary and Section 89 relief: Salary arrears received in a year — back-pay, a Pay Commission payout, or a retirement settlement — can push the taxpayer into a higher slab. Section 89(1), with Form 10E (an online declaration filed to claim tax relief under the said Section), allows spreading the income over the

years it relates to and claiming the differential as relief. The arithmetic is non-trivial; omitting Form 10E — a common slip — disallows the relief at intimation.

ESOPs, RSUs and SARs for IT professionals: IT and ITes employees frequently receive ESOPs, RSUs or SARs from foreign-listed parent companies. The perquisite arises at exercise and capital gains at sale; fair market value at exercise must be tracked, and shares held in foreign demat accounts disclosed in Schedule FA (foreign assets). Errors here have triggered a sharp uptick in notices to the IT workforce; a CA familiar with the pathway is now a necessity.

Foreign assets and Black Money Act exposure: Salaried employees on overseas deputation, residents holding foreign bank accounts, and small businessmen with overseas vendor balances must disclose foreign assets in Schedule FA. The Black Money Act prescribes severe consequences for omission, and a self-filer must exercise extreme caution while completing this schedule to avoid complications at a later date.

Multi-property scenarios: Two or more house properties — common among small businessmen with rental income — invoke deemed-let-out provisions, joint-ownership computations and the interest-deduction interplay between principal residence and let-out properties. Schedule HP

leaves a wide room for error.

Notice or scrutiny history: A taxpayer with any prior notice — assessment, reassessment, demand or even a query from the department relating to refund — should not revert to self-filing. The case file in the CA's office speaks for the taxpayer at later stages.

POST-FILING — INTIMATION AND BEYOND

Once e-verified, the return is processed within weeks and an intimation under Section 143(1) follows. The self-filer faces this alone; the practitioner typically handles it as a courtesy; the CA handles intimation, rectification and Demand Facilitation Centre communications formally. Where the matter proceeds to scrutiny (under Section 143(2)) or reassessment (under Section 148), a CA's expertise becomes the logical choice.

WHICH ROUTE FOR WHICH TAXPAYER

A simple rule. Salary, bank interest and minor investments — self-filing is adequate. Capital gains from listed equity or mutual funds, or rental income from one property — a tax practitioner suffices. Salary arrears, ESOPs or RSUs, foreign assets, multiple properties, or presumptive small business income with mixed receipts — engage a chartered accountant.

Two further situations sit

Three routes to one return

Self • Tax practitioner • Chartered accountant

OPTION 1
Self
0 cost
Full control. Free
Best suited for:
Salary + bank interest,
ITR-1 cases, first-time filers learning

OPTION 2
Practitioner
₹500-3,000
Procedural ease. Affordable
Best suited for:
Salary + investments,
one or two house properties, Standard ITR-2 cases

OPTION 3
CA
₹3,000-15,000
Full lifecycle coverage
Best suited for:
Arrears, ESOPs, RSUs,
Foreign assets, multi-properties, notice / scrutiny history

RETURN FILED

Quick facts

Filing route	Level of expertise required	Remarks
Self-filing	Basic — comfort with the e-filing portal and one's own pay-slips and bank statements	Suits simple salary cases — Form 16, bank interest, and pre-fill driven data
Tax practitioner	Procedural — software-led return preparation	Suits salary plus a few investments; standard ITR-2 cases
Chartered Accountant	Professional — advisory across the full lifecycle, planning to scrutiny*	Best for arrears (Section 89), ESOPs/RSUs, foreign assets, multi-property and any notice/scrutiny history

*Professional fee for a CA varies by complexity of the return

At a glance — who does what

Dimension	Self-filing	Tax practitioner	Chartered Accountant
Pre-filing planning	Self-driven	Limited	Comprehensive
Regime advisory (old vs new)	Self-judgment	Limited	Based on prior-year history
ITR vs AIS reconciliation	Manual	Software-checked	Working-paper based
Section 89 / Form 10E	Risky	Variable	Reliable
ESOP / RSU / Schedule FA	Risky	Limited	Reliable
NRI returns / Form 67 (FTC)	Risky	Variable	Reliable
Intimation handling	Self	Courtesy	Formal
Scrutiny / reassessment	Weak	Limited	Strong
Working-paper retention	Self	Variable	Yes

firmly in CA territory. NRI returns — with their layered residential status rules and DTAA (double taxation avoidance agreements) interplay — demand specialist expertise. So do foreign tax-credit claims by residents: Where tax has been withheld abroad, Form 67 must be filed before the return; a missed or delayed Form 67 forfeits the relief altogether.

An unintended error in any of these areas can lead to under- or mis-reporting of income, with exposure to penalty and interest under Sections 270A and 234A/B/C. Professional guidance — and the fee it carries — becomes not a dis-

cretionary cost, but a necessity.

THE TAKEAWAY

The income-tax return is no longer an annual ritual; it underpins credit access, visa applications and refund claims, while increasingly coming under greater scrutiny. For the salaried employee with a clean Form 16, the portal is built for you — use it. For the rest, professional hand-holding is the prudent course.

The author is a Partner at Venkatesh and Co."VCO". With inputs from CA Hrishikesh D & CA Manikarnika B. The views expressed here are the author's and not of bl portfolio

Diversification emerges as the winning strategy in H1 2026

Asset class performance grid

Ranking by returns in H1 2026 and over different investment horizons (%)

H1 2026	1-year	2-year	3-year	5-year	7-year	10-year	15-year	20-year
US 13.5	Silver 104.3	Silver 58.9	Silver 46.6	Silver 26.2	Silver 28.6	US 19.5	US 20.3	Mid 16.2
China 9.5	Gold 44.6	Gold 40.3	Gold 33.7	Gold 24.4	Gold 22.4	Mid 18.7	Mid 17.4	US 15.4
Small 6.3	China 35.7	China 28	US 26.7	US 18.6	US 21.2	Silver 17.8	Small 14.9	Gold 14.8
ST Debt 5.6	US 33.6	US 24.8	Mid 20.9	Mid 18.4	Mid 21	Gold 16.3	Gold 13.1	Silver 14.1
Gold 5.4	Mid 5.8	ST Debt 7	Small 20.3	Small 17	Small 20.4	Small 16	Large 11.7	Small 14
LT Debt 4.8	ST Debt 5.6	Mid 5.4	China 16.1	Large 10	Large 12	Large 12.9	Silver 10.1	Large 12.2
Mid 2.4	LT Debt 3	LT Debt 5.3	Large 10.1	China 6.2	China 9.3	China 6.7	China 7.4	China 9.3
Silver -4.7	Small 2	Small 2.5	ST Debt 6.9	ST Debt 6.1	ST Debt 6.3	LT Debt 6.5	LT Debt 7.3	ST Debt 7.2
Large -7.4	Large -3.5	Large 1.9	LT Debt 6.1	LT Debt 5.4	LT Debt 6	ST Debt 6.4	ST Debt 7.2	LT Debt 7.1

For Large, Nifty 50 index; for Mid, Nifty Midcap 150; for Small, Nifty Smallcap 250; for US, S&P 500 (INR); for China, Shanghai Stock Exchange Composite (INR) For Long-Term Debt, average of Long duration, Medium to Long duration and Gilt MF schemes, for Short-Term Debt, average of Low duration, Ultra short duration and Money market funds. For Gold, MCX India gold spot index and for Silver, MCX India silver spot index were considered. Source: Niftyindices.com, Bloomberg and ACEMF. H1 2026 was as of June 26, 2026 Total return indices were considered for all domestic and overseas equity markets, except for China, where the price return index was used. Absolute returns (up to 1 year); CAGR (above 1 year)

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

The first half of 2026 saw a notable shift in leadership across asset classes. Within Indian equities, the performance gap widened sharply. Large-cap stocks declined 7.4 per cent year-to-date (YTD), weighed down by valuation correction and persistent foreign portfolio outflows. In contrast, mid- and small-cap stocks delivered positive returns of 2.4 per cent and 6.3 per cent respectively.

For Indian investors with international exposure, overseas equities emerged as the better performers. The US market gained 13.5 per cent, while China delivered 9.5 per cent return in INR terms.

Among commodities, gold gained 5.4 per cent, while silver declined 4.7 per cent in INR terms. This decline in silver overshadows its peak YTD return during H1 of 66 per cent highlighting its extreme volatile nature.

Fixed-income investments continued to provide stability. Short-term debt delivered 5.6 per cent, outper-

forming long-term debt, which returned 4.8 per cent. With the interest-rate trajectory remaining uncertain, accrual-oriented short-duration strategies offered a better risk-reward trade-off than duration-heavy portfolios.

However, overall when the investment horizon is extended, gold and silver have delivered the best returns, topping the table across periods ranging from one to seven years. On a 10-year basis, the S&P 500 takes the top spot, while India's Midcap 150 ranks second.

ALERTS.

Enhanced 3-in-1 account experience

AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB) and Motilal Oswal Financial Services (MOFSL) have jointly announced a significant enhancement to their three-in-one Account proposition. The upgrade introduces a new fund-blocking feature designed to make trading more seamless, efficient and financially rewarding for investors. A three-in-one account is an integrated banking solution that combines a savings account, a trading account and a demat account into a single, seamless platform, allowing customers to manage their money, invest in shares and hold securities without the need to move funds between different accounts.

Eco-friendly co-branded twin credit cards

Punjab National Bank (PNB) has partnered with Zaggie Prepaid Ocean Services to launch the PNB-Zaggie co-branded twin credit cards. The offerings combine rewarding lifestyle benefits with sustainability. Manufactured using biodegradable materials, the credit cards are available on dual network offered as a primary card. The twin benefit proposition brings together the global acceptance and travel privileges of Visa and lifestyle benefits of RuPay with the UPI-enabled convenience.

CELEBRATING THE QUIET DREAMERS WHO DRIVE POWERFUL CHANGE.

If you know someone whose financial innovations have redefined the industry - or if that someone is you - nominate them (or yourself) for the **Financial Transformation Award**.

Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026CFN to nominate yourself or someone you know.

NOMINATIONS OPEN NOW

Other categories include:

- Digital Transformation
- Young Changemaker
- Social Transformation
- Changemaker of the Year

CM YK A CH-CHE



Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

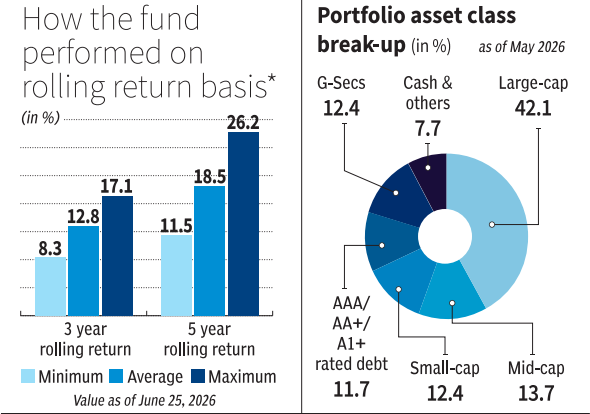
UTI Aggressive Hybrid Fund (UAHF) stands out in the aggressive hybrid fund category for its disciplined value-oriented approach to equity investing. Rather than chasing market momentum, the fund invests in fundamentally strong companies trading below their intrinsic value. While such a strategy demands patience, as the market can take time to recognise the true worth of these businesses, it has rewarded long-term investors with consistent performance.

The fund has remained an above-average performer within its category over the long run. Among the oldest hybrid mutual funds in India, UAHF has a track record spanning more than three decades and has delivered an annualised return of 14.5 per cent since its launch in March 1995.

As mandated by the regulator, aggressive hybrid funds invest 65-80 per cent of their portfolio in equities and 20-35 per cent in debt instruments, seeking to balance growth with stability. This asset mix makes them suitable for investors with a moderate risk appetite.

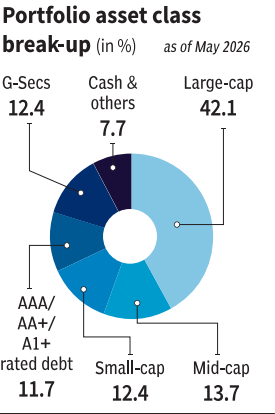
EQUITY STRATEGY

UTI Aggressive Hybrid Fund follows a dynamic asset al-



location strategy, maintaining equity exposure between 66 per cent and 74 per cent over the past five years, with the balance invested in debt. On the equity side, the fund is managed like a flexi-cap strategy, allocating roughly two-thirds of its equity portfolio to large-cap stocks. Over the last five years, large-cap exposure averaged 48 per cent of total assets, while the remainder was invested in mid- and small-cap stocks.

The fund follows a relative value investment approach, favouring companies trading below their historical valuations or at discounts relative to peers and benchmark valuations. Its core equity portfolio is built around large-cap companies with strong fundamentals that are considered



WHY INVEST

- Three-decade performance record
- Category-beating rolling returns
- Moderate-risk asset mix

undervalued relative to their long-term earnings potential. The allocation to mid- and small-cap stocks seeks to generate alpha through a combination of undervalued businesses, turnaround opportunities and companies offering growth at reasonable valuations.

Stock selection follows a structured valuation framework rather than relying on a single metric. Banks are assessed primarily using price-to-book multiples, IT companies through price-to-earnings ratios, commodity businesses using EV/EBITDA, real estate companies through price-to-net asset value, and insurance companies based on price-to-embedded value.

The fund continues to emphasise valuation discipline over market mo-

mentum. While this approach has supported long-term returns, it can result in temporary periods of underperformance when richly-valued growth sectors dominate market gains.

Currently, the fund is overweight on IT, banking and telecom, while remaining underweight on capital goods, consumer durables and automobiles, where valuations are considered stretched despite strong recent performance. Banks, IT and pharmaceuticals remain the top three sector exposures. Over the past year, the fund increased allocations to construction, power and insurance by 1-2 percentage

points, while reducing exposure to banks, oil and gas, and metals by 2-4 percentage points.

DEBT STRATEGY

The debt portfolio follows a high-quality strategy, with most of its investments allocated to AAA-rated corporate bonds or government securities over the past five years. According to the latest portfolio, government securities account for 12.4 per cent of assets, while AAA-rated corporate bonds constitute 9.8 per cent. AA+ rated securities account for 1.6 per cent of the portfolio, with holdings including Cholamandalam Investment & Finance, Muthoot Finance, Piramal Capital & Housing Finance, and Torrent Pharmaceuticals. The fund has maintained portfolio duration in the four-seven year range over the last five years.

RETURNS

The fund delivered strong performance between 2020 and 2025, benefiting from the outperformance of value stocks and robust gains in its small-cap holdings. During this period, it generated an annualised return of 18.5 per cent, comfortably ahead of the category average of 16.2 per cent.

Performance over the past year, however, broadly matched the category, with the fund declining around 1

per cent. The weaker showing was driven by three factors: An overweight position in IT during a period of sector weakness, a deliberate avoidance of high-flying sectors such as defence, capital goods and power, and stock-specific disappointments within parts of the small-cap portfolio.

The fund has consistently outperformed the category on a rolling return basis. Its average five-year rolling return stands at 18.5 per cent, compared with the category average of 16 per cent, with rolling returns ranging between 12 per cent and 26 per cent. On a three-year rolling basis, it has delivered an average CAGR of 18 per cent versus the category average of 15 per cent.

The regular plan carries a base expense ratio of 1.54 per cent, lower than the category average of 1.73 per cent. However, the direct plan's expense ratio of 0.98 per cent is marginally higher than the category average of 0.72 per cent.

The fund is best suited for long-term investors who can remain invested through temporary phases of underperformance without reacting to short-term market trends. Investors can invest through a systematic investment plan (SIP) and maintain an investment horizon of at least five years.

ALERTS.

Tata Multi-sector Passive FoF NFO

Tata Asset Management has announced the launch of Tata Multi-sector Passive FoF, an open-ended fund of fund (FoF) scheme investing in units of passive equity mutual fund schemes across multiple sectors. The scheme seeks to generate long-term capital appreciation through active allocation to passive sector-oriented funds and ETFs. The New Fund Offer (NFO) closes for subscription on July 6. The fund employs

factors such as momentum-based allocation framework etc. to invest across sector index funds and ETFs. Minimum application amount is ₹5,000 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. Exit load of 0.50 per cent is applicable if redeemed within 30 days of allotment.

JM Multi Asset Allocation Fund NFO

JM Financial Mutual Fund has launched JM Multi Asset Allocation Fund, an open-ended scheme investing in equity and equity-related instruments, debt and money market securities, gold/silver-related instruments and other exchange-traded commodity derivatives. The NFO closes on July 8. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked with Composite of Nifty 500 (55 per cent) + CRISIL Short term bond Index (30 per cent) + Domestic Price of Gold (10 per cent) + Domestic Price of silver (5 per cent). An exit load of 1 per cent is payable if units are redeemed/switched-out within 60 days from the date of allotment. The minimum subscription amount is ₹5,000.



CRAFTSMAN AUTOMATION LIMITED

(CIN: L28991TZ1986PLC001816)

Registered Office: 123/4, Sangothipalayam Road, Arasur Post, Coimbatore - 641407
Web: www.craftsmanautomation.com, **Email:** investor@craftsmanautomation.com

NOTICE OF 40TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

NOTICE is hereby given that the 40th Annual General Meeting ('AGM') of the Members of Craftsman Automation Limited ('the Company') will be held through Video Conference ("VC") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("OAVM") on **Thursday, the 23rd July, 2026 at 4.00 P.M. IST** in compliance with all the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder and the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) ("LODR") Regulations, 2015, read with the Circulars issued by the SEBI (the latest circular dated 3rd October, 2024) and the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") from time to time (the latest circular dated 22nd September, 2025) ("Circulars") to transact the businesses as set forth in the Notice calling the AGM.

In Compliance with the above-mentioned MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars, the Annual Report including the financial statements for the financial year ended 31st March, 2026 and the report of Directors and Auditors thereon along with the Notice of the 40th AGM is being sent on 27th June, 2026 only through electronic mode, to all the Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the CDSL / NSDL (Depositories) or Company /Registrar & Share Transfer Agents (RTA) viz. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited) and is also available on the Company's website at www.craftsmanautomation.com and on the website of CDSL at www.evotingindia.com. The same is also displayed on the website of the Stock Exchanges viz. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com. Further, the Company in accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, is also sending a letter to the Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses with the Depositories or Company or RTA, containing the weblink including the exact path where the complete details of the Annual Report is available.

Members can attend and participate in the AGM through the VC/OAVM facility only. The instructions for joining the AGM electronically are provided in the Notice of the AGM. Members attending the meeting through VC/OAVM shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. The facility for the appointment of a proxy will not be available for the AGM.

The Company is pleased to provide electronic voting facility to all its Members to exercise their vote by electronic means on all resolutions set forth in the Notice of the AGM through the platform provided by Central Depository Services India Limited (CDSL). Members have the option to cast their vote on all of the resolutions using remote e-voting facility or e-voting during the AGM. Detailed procedure for remote e-voting/ e-voting during the AGM is provided in the notes of the notice of the AGM.

Members are requested to note the following:

- i. Only those Members, whose names are recorded in Register of Members or in Register of Beneficial Owners (in case of electronic shareholding) maintained by Depositories as on cut-off date i.e., Thursday, the 16th July, 2026 will be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting, participation at the AGM and voting during the AGM;
- ii. In case a person has become a Member of the Company after dispatch of the AGM notice but on or before the cut off date for e voting, he/she may obtain the credentials in the manner as mentioned in the notice of AGM;
- iii. Remote e-voting period shall commence on Monday, the 20th July, 2026 at 9.00 A.M. (IST) and ends on Wednesday, the 22nd July, 2026 at 5.00 P.M. (IST). The e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL thereafter;
- iv. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently;
- v. The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend/participate in the AGM through VC / OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again;
- vi. Those Members, who will be present in the AGM through VC/OAVM facility and have not cast their vote on the Resolutions through remote e-voting are otherwise not barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through e-voting system during the AGM;
- vii. All queries or issues regarding attending AGM & e-voting from the CDSL e-Voting System, you can write an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdsindia.com or contact at Toll Free No. 1800 21 09911;
- viii. All grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means may be addressed to Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, Assistant Vice President, (CDSL) Central Depository Services (India) Limited, A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdsindia.com or call on Toll Free No. 1800 21 09911.

The Board of Directors of the Company have appointed Dr. C.V.Madhusudhanan, Partner, failing him Mr. V.R.Sankaranarayanan, Partner of M/s. KSR & Co Company Secretaries LLP, Coimbatore, Practicing Company Secretaries as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting process and voting through the electronic voting system at the AGM in a fair and transparent manner.

The result declared along with the Scrutinizer's Report will be placed on the Company's website www.craftsmanautomation.com and on the website of CDSL e-voting (www.evotingindia.com) immediately after the declaration of result and the same will also be communicated to BSE Limited and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited.

NOTICE is hereby given that the Register of Members of the Company will remain closed from Friday, the 17th July, 2026 to Thursday, the 23rd July, 2026 (both days inclusive) for the purpose of the AGM and payment of Dividend. Dividend for the financial year 2025-26, if declared at the 40th AGM, will be paid to the Members whose name appear on the Register of Members and to the Beneficial Owners of Shares as per the details furnished by the Depositories, as the case may be, as at the close of business hours on Thursday, the 16th July, 2026. Pursuant to the Income-Tax Act, 2025, dividends paid or distributed by the Company is taxable in the hands of the Members and the Company is required to deduct TDS at the prescribed rates from the dividend to be paid to Members. The detailed process of the same is provided in the AGM Notice. Members are requested to update their Permanent Account Number ("PAN") with the Company and Depositories (in case of shares held in demat mode) on or before Thursday, the 16th July, 2026.

Members are requested to carefully read all the notes set out in the notice of the AGM and in particular, instructions for joining the AGM, manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or e-voting during the AGM.

By Order of the Board
For Craftsman Automation Limited
Sd/-
Shainshad Aduvanni
Company Secretary

Date: 28.06.2026
Place: Coimbatore

SpaceX bond loss stuns traders

Bloomberg

SpaceX's blockbuster bond sale is weakening so quickly in the secondary market that traders say they can't recall another recent deal that widened this sharply.

One large dealer was quoting SpaceX bonds maturing in 2056 at levels as much as 0.28 percentage point wider than the issue price of 1.75 percentage points above Treasuries, according to people with knowledge of the matter, who asked not to be identified discussing private activity in the over-the-counter market.

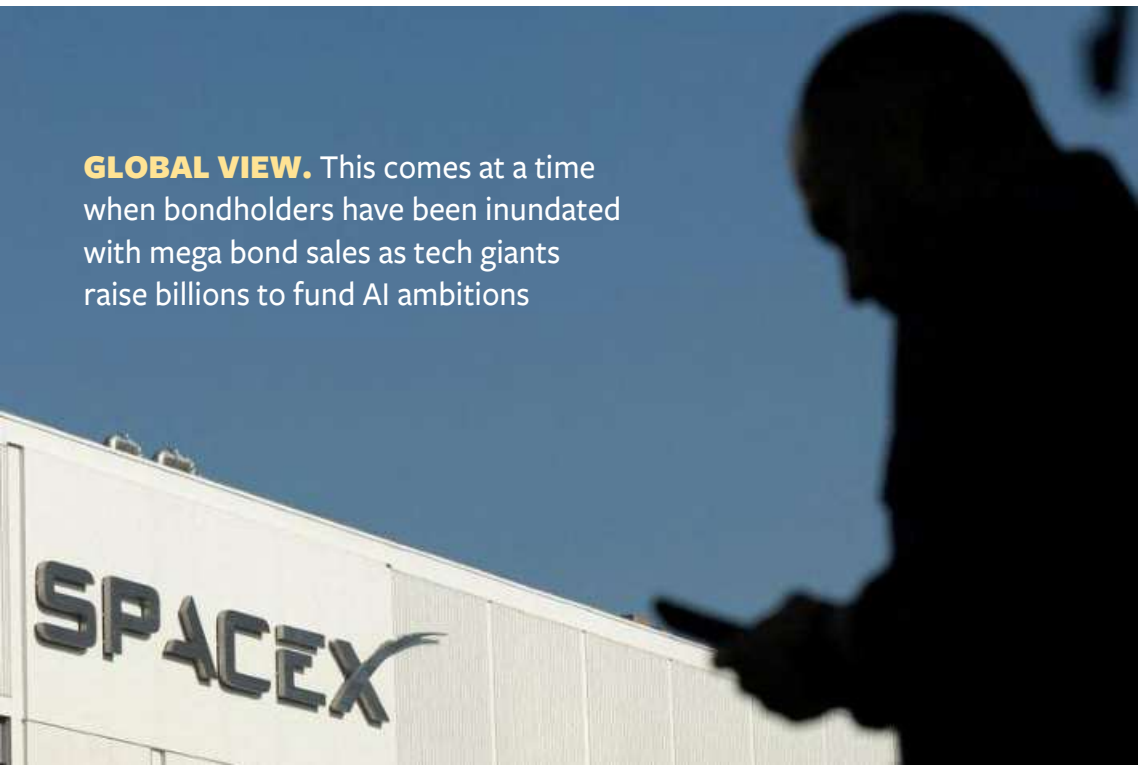
Paper losses on SpaceX's \$25-billion offering have mounted since the debt began trading and totalled roughly \$305 million as of late Thursday relative to Treasuries. The longest-dated SpaceX bonds, which drew more scepticism than those with shorter maturities, have effectively erased all the tightening from underwriters that followed as orders swelled to nearly \$90 billion.

SELLING PRESSURE

Traders say the moves suggest fast-money accounts, rather than traditional buy-and-hold investors, piled into the deal looking to flip it for a quick profit. The selling pressure stands out even more because SpaceX shares have been largely stable since the bonds priced on Tuesday, after lurching 16 per cent lower the day before.

Even if there are more technical reasons behind the selling — hedge funds covering or hedging short positions, for example — the virtually-unprecedented magnitude points to SpaceX's unique profile. The company, which at its peak this month had a \$2.64 trillion market value, won investment grades despite expectations for years of negative cash flow and a dependence on Elon Musk that Fitch Ratings deemed a "key rating constraint."

"We expected SpaceX to widen from issuance level, but not this much," said Tony Trzcinka, a portfolio manager at Impax Asset Management. "That magnitude is likely a per-



REUTERS

GLOBAL VIEW. This comes at a time when bondholders have been inundated with mega bond sales as tech giants raise billions to fund AI ambitions

● **CLEAR PREFERENCE**

Demand for the SpaceX bond sale was strongest for the five-year notes, while interest was weaker in the 20-year and 30-year bonds

dated bonds also widened soon after they were first sold.

Tech stocks dragged global indexes lower Friday following renewed selling in chipmakers, while a report that OpenAI could postpone plans to go public also weighed on sentiment. Two of China's best-known hedge fund managers are warning that the artificial intelligence boom in global stock markets has become an unsustainable bubble.

DEMAND TRENDS

Demand for the SpaceX bond sale was strongest for the five-year notes, which let the company cut borrowing costs more on that portion of the deal

than on the longer maturities. Interest was weaker in the 20-year and 30-year bonds, which saw the biggest drop-off in demand.

A representative for SpaceX didn't immediately respond to a request for comment, and the banks that managed the bond sale didn't provide comment on SpaceX trading levels.

Bondholders have been inundated with mega bond sales this year as tech giants race to raise billions of dollars to finance artificial intelligence projects.

The US high-grade supply of \$175 billion as of Tuesday has set a new June record, surpassing 2020's \$169-billion haul.

Credit-default swaps tied to SpaceX bonds began trading actively this week, Bloomberg reported on Thursday, allowing investors to hedge against potential losses or speculate on the firm's creditworthiness. That creates more two-sided activity, or more ways to take exposure, which could boost trading in the bonds.

Clean air, clearer prospects

AUTO COMPONENTS. Exhaust systems supplier, Tenneco Clean Air, stands to gain from next-gen emission norms

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

We had recommended investors subscribe to the IPO of tier-I automotive parts supplier Tenneco Clean Air India (TCAIL) in November 2025. The issue price then was ₹397 per share. TCAIL's shares have since had a good rally, marking an all-time high of ₹657 in early May to trade at ₹579 now — about 12 per cent below the said high.

Fundamentally, the company has had a decent year in FY26, with revenue, value-added revenue (refer footnote of chart) and net income (adjusted for one-offs) growing 10.5 per cent, 12.3 per cent and 13.1 per cent respectively. While that may not have been the reason behind the market's exuberance, the street seems to be more cheerful about the company's prospects in the medium term.

TCAIL, which supplies exhaust systems for passenger vehicles (PVs) and commercial vehicles (CVs), stands to gain from the next generation of emission norms namely, CAFE III (from FY28) and BS-VII (date to be notified) in India and Euro 7 (from November 2026) in the EU. Besides, as a market leader in suspension parts, TCAIL is also a beneficiary of a premiumisation trend occurring in PV suspension systems. Consequently, the order-book has swollen to ₹12,400 crore, lending earnings visibility. This is about 2.3x FY26 revenue.

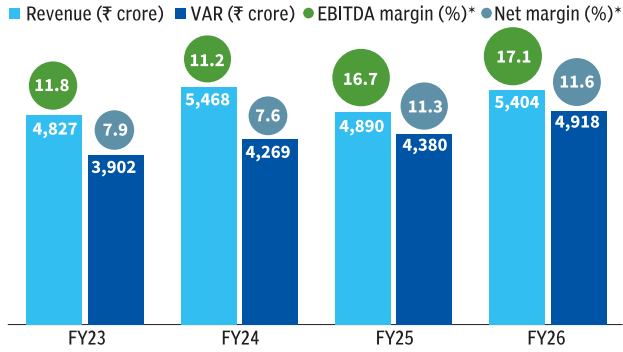
The stock trades at 33x the likely earnings in FY27. In the last two years, the company's earnings have grown at a CAGR of a little over 20 per cent and is likely to remain decent going forward. Our analysis indicates that TCAIL can sustain this growth rate for the next two years as well. This implies a PEG (price-earnings-growth) ratio of around 1.5-1.75x, which is reasonable. However, accumulating on dips offers better margin of safety given cyclical and current volatile markets.

BUSINESS IN BRIEF

TCAIL is part of the US-based Tenneco Group, which operates in 28 countries with a revenue of over \$17 billion. The company op-



Financial snapshot



Value added revenue (VAR) = Revenue minus cost of substrates (made of platinum/palladium/ rhodium used in catalytic converters). Cost of substrates is passed through to OEMs without much value addition.
FY26 net margin is adjusted for one-offs *as a % of revenue Source: Exchange filings

erates two verticals: A) Clean air and powertrain solutions and B) Advanced ride technologies. Under A, it manufactures products such as diesel oxidation catalyst, diesel particulate filter, mufflers and resonators that fall under 'clean air' or exhaust solutions and products such as spark plugs, ignition coils, head gaskets and bearings falling under powertrain solutions. Under B, it produces shock absorbers and strut assemblies. TCAIL makes about 49 per cent and 51 per cent of revenue from A and B respectively. The end-use wise revenue split is as follows: PVs 65 per cent, CVs 21 per cent, industrials 7 per cent, aftermarket 4 per cent and others 3 per cent. Exports account for about 6 per cent of value-added revenue.

TCAIL is a market leader with over 50 per cent market share in key product offerings.

Business is run quite efficiently at TCAIL. It has generated sizeable return on equity between 38 per cent and 43 per cent in the last three years and is also net-debt free. Its manufacturing lines are modular and flexible to support production of more than one kind of product, resulting in a fixed asset turnover ratio that has ranged between 8-10x in the last three years. Working capital-wise, it enjoys negative cash conversion cycle days which implies high efficiency.

ORDER-BOOK DEEP DIVE

As of March 2026, TCAIL's order-book stands at ₹12,400 crore. This is an estimate of incremental cumulative revenue that can be recognised from orders that are yet to see the start of production. In FY26, the company has won multiple orders, which include supply of bearings systems and

ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

Tenneco Clean Air India ₹579.15

WHY

- Market leader in key offerings
- Exports ramp-up expected
- Highly-efficient financials

gasoline particulate filters (for CAFE-III compliance) to a leading Japanese PV OEM (appears to be Maruti Suzuki based on contextual understanding). This marks the first order-win from this OEM under the clean air vertical and opens up volume advantages owing to the OEM's market share.

Exports (largely to Europe) are also part of the order-book. TCAIL will export products to Tenneco's group companies in Europe and the US, and such companies will serve the clients there. The company has secured an aftertreatment (exhaust) programme from a leading European CV OEM. It has also completed a Euro-7 compliant proof-of-concept for a European CV OEM (not clear whether the two European OEMs are the same). Content per vehicle (CPV) tends to be 3-4x higher for CVs versus that for PVs.

Per the management, exports represent 14-20 per cent of the order-book. Export margins are ex-

pected to be on par with domestic, if not higher.

TAILWINDS

With a new generation of emission regulations round the corner, OEMs need to work with component suppliers such as TCAIL to develop compliant exhaust parts. Stringent regulations typically translate to a higher number of parts or a higher complexity of the technology used in those parts — in turn translating to higher content per vehicle and revenue for TCAIL. For instance, in case of PV powertrains based on gasoline direct injection technology (commonplace in turbocharged engines), there is increased emission of particulate matter, which would need the addition of a gasoline particulate filter in the exhaust system, to be compliant with the new CAFE-III norms. TCAIL is incurring a capex of about ₹70 crore in a greenfield capacity in Haryana to support vertical 'A'.

When it comes to suspension systems, cars in the entry to premium segment have, so far, largely been equipped with passive suspension — meaning the suspension is not tuned differently for different surfaces; it does not differentiate whether the vehicle is on a well-paved highway or a pothole-ridden uneven road. If a car is tuned to handle corners well at high speed, it typically has a harsh ride on an uneven road.

This, however, is beginning to change. Tenneco has piloted its DaVinci DCx suspension system on Mahindra's recently-launched XUV 7XO. The system uses specially-engineered discs, known as shim stacks, to regulate the flow of hydraulic fluid and deliver adaptive damping — a solution for the above problem. According to the management, DaVinci DCx can offer comfort levels close to those of more expensive control valve semi-active (CVSA) systems, while avoiding the electronics and software complexity that CVSA entails. In the Q4 earnings call, the management disclosed that three-four OEMs had enquired about the system following its success in the XUV 7XO. TCAIL is adding capacity under vertical 'B' in Maharashtra, at a cost of ₹70 crore.

The ride is worth revisiting

AMUSEMENT PARKS. Wonderla offers recovery upside, but Chennai & Hyderabad assets have to deliver consistently

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

In February 2023, *bl portfolio* had recommended investors accumulate amusement park operator Wonderla Holidays at about ₹425. That call initially played out well. The stock later climbed to an all-time high of ₹1,106.70 on April 8, 2024. Since then, however, it has been a sharp ride down. At the latest BSE close of ₹495.65, the stock is just about 17 per cent above the old recommendation price. It is also down about 55 per cent from its peak.

Part of the correction is easy to understand. The post-Covid rebound years were exceptional, with revenue growth of over 200 per cent in FY22 and FY23, but growth cooled to 13.3 per cent in FY24 and declined by 5 per cent in FY25 (up 13 per cent in FY26); EBITDA margin has also slipped from 49.7 per cent in FY23 to 31.7 per cent in FY26. The story is similar for its bottomline (see table).

The decline in stock price changes the discussion. While Wonderla is not a low-risk bargain, it is no longer a stock where everything needs to go right to justify investor attention with scope for outperformance over the long term. Risk to factor is that at the current market capitalisation of about ₹3,145 crore, it remains a small-cap stock. Liquidity, seasonality and execution of course matter.

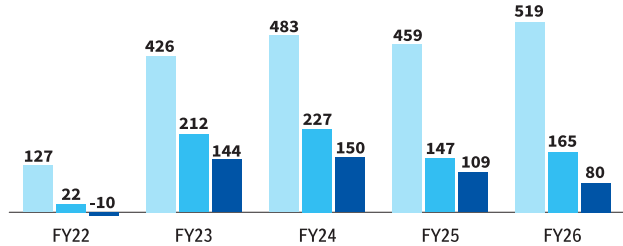
Our call now is accumulate on dips, with a minimum three-year view. The stock trades at about 38 times FY26 earnings, 28 times one-year forward earnings (this is at a good 20 per cent discount to five-year average) and 21 times two-year forward earnings, per Bloomberg. Company EPS is estimated to rise 38 per cent in FY27 and another 32 per cent in FY28. That improvement can come from Chennai's full-year contribution, better cost absorption and recovery in park-level margins.

BUSINESS

Started in 2000, Wonderla is the leading amusement park operator

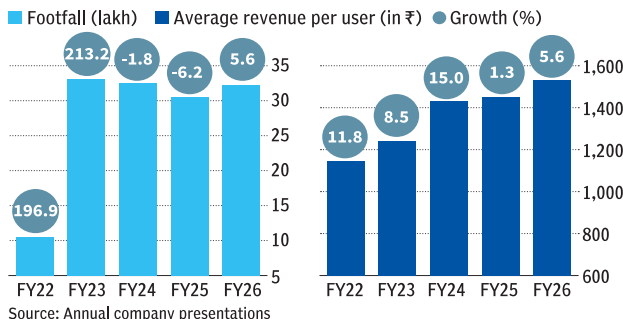


Financials (in ₹ cr)



All numbers are adjusted and rounded off Source: Bloomberg, company filings

Performance



Source: Annual company presentations

in India. It runs 5 parks in Kochi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Bhubaneswar and Chennai (commenced operations in December). That scale is bigger than listed peers such as Nicco Parks & Resorts and Imagicaaworld Entertainment. Wonderla also has a resort and hospitality business, mainly linked to its park ecosystem. Its revenue comes from entry tickets, food and beverages, retail, resort stays, events and other guest spends. The company signed off FY26 with about ₹519 crore in revenue (up 13 per cent), ₹165 crore in EBITDA (up 12.2 per cent) and about ₹80 crore in net profit, per Bloomberg.

The business is simple, but difficult to build. A park needs large land parcels, water availability, safety systems, maintenance capability and local permissions. Wonderla also has a history of making some rides in-house. That helps in cost control and maintenance. The company's brand has been built over many years, especially in South India.

The financial position is comfortable. Based on Bloomberg data, cash stood at about ₹424 crore, while debt was only around ₹6 crore. This gives Wonderla the balance-sheet strength to invest. The issue is how quickly and profitably capital can be deployed.

ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

Wonderla Holidays ₹495.65

WHY

- Valuations appear reasonable
- Footfalls, margins need stronger growth
- Earnings recovery visible ahead

WHAT HAS CHANGED

What has changed since the last call is scale and expectations. Chennai has started operations and is now central to the story. The park had around 75,000 visitors in December, its launch month, with Q4FY26 footfalls of around 1.91 lakh. The management said the park had performed in line with some mature parks (Kochi, Hyderabad) in its first full quarter. Chennai also delivered about 30 per cent EBITDA margin. That is a good start for a new park.

There is also headroom in non-ticket revenue. The management said the current mix is about 70 per cent ticket revenue and 30 per cent non-ticket revenue. It expects this to move towards 60:40 in the near term and possibly 50:50 over four-five years. The company has focussed in terms of offerings, the assortment of products and how it is able to increase dwelling time and customer engagement to be able to increase the non-ticketing revenue (already growing faster than ticket revenue). While in the mid-to long-term, despite discretionary spend softening, company is confident that the footfall will continue to bring a good ARPU (FY26: ₹1,530, up nearly 6 per cent year on year), and that should mitigate some of the business risks.

WHAT NEEDS TO IMPROVE

What needs to get better is equally clear. First, footfall growth must

improve. FY26 total footfalls were 32.19 lakh, up only about 6 per cent from 30.49 lakh in FY25. That is modest, considering the company has added parks over time. The market will not reward only capacity addition. It will reward sustained visits.

Second, Hyderabad needs a turnaround. That park's footfalls in FY26 were down 7 per cent, and the management attributed it to weather, early monsoon, school-group softness and one-off road-related restrictions. These may be valid explanations. But repeated weakness in a large mature market cannot be ignored.

Third, Chennai must prove itself across a full year. Launch curiosity, school holidays and marketing can lift early numbers. The real test is whether footfalls sustain through lean months, monsoon periods and normalised marketing spends.

Fourth, expansion needs more visibility. The company raised capital for growth (₹540-crore QIP in Dec-2024 at ₹790/share), but new park announcements have been slower than expected. The management says it is speaking to multiple State governments and is now focussing more on tier-1 markets. Note that in tier-1 cities like Mumbai, Delhi and Ahmedabad, it's much harder to find good parcels of land and dealing with the government also takes more time. Typical capex for a new park is upwards of ₹350 crore.

Finally, margins must move up. In FY25, EBITDA margin declined to 32.1 per cent; bulk of the decline was due to increase in employee expenses and ad spends (partially linked to upcoming park launch). The margin has stayed somewhat flat in FY26. The management says historical margins would be around 40 per cent, excluding post Covid rebound years. So, it is crucial to monitor how margin trends from hereon. A recovery will depend on Chennai scale-up, Hyderabad recovery, and corporate cost control. Bloomberg consensus estimates imply margins moving up to 34 per cent in FY27 and 36 per cent in FY28.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	June 19	June 25		
M & M	3,074.7	3,181.8	▲	3.5
ICICI Bank	1,346.8	1,387.9	▲	3.1
Maruti Suzuki	13,393.1	13,741.8	▲	2.6
Kotak Mahindra Bank	398.9	409.0	▲	2.5
HDFC Bank	780.0	796.1	▲	2.1
Bajaj Finance	961.3	979.9	▲	1.9
Tech Mahindra	1,410.8	1,436.7	▲	1.8
Axis Bank	1,357.8	1,376.6	▲	1.4
Sun Pharma	1,837.2	1,862.2	▲	1.4
UltraTech Cement	11,371.0	11,493.3	▲	1.1
SBI	1,035.1	1,045.2	▲	1.0
Reliance Industries	1,309.4	1,318.3	▲	0.7
Trent	3,204.3	3,217.3	▲	0.4
L&T	4,209.6	4,220.0	▲	0.2
Bajaj Finserv	1,766.2	1,764.2	▼	-0.1
Infosys	1,051.9	1,041.4	▼	-1.0
HUL	2,195.9	2,173.3	▼	-1.0
ITC	293.4	290.1	▼	-1.1
TCS	2,126.4	2,095.6	▼	-1.4
Tata Motors PV	359.5	353.2	▼	-1.8
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,835.1	1,796.3	▼	-2.1
HCL Tech	1,129.8	1,101.5	▼	-2.5
Power Grid	292.4	284.0	▼	-2.9
Titan	4,423.2	4,289.7	▼	-3.0
Bharti Airtel	1,908.6	1,850.2	▼	-3.1
Asian Paints	2,733.8	2,645.9	▼	-3.2
Eternal	264.2	255.3	▼	-3.4
NTPC	365.8	352.2	▼	-3.7
Bharat Electronics	427.2	406.8	▼	-4.8
Tata Steel	198.9	188.7	▼	-5.1

How sectoral indices moved

	June 19	June 25	Movement	% change
REALTY	6,337.7	6,447.4	▲	1.7
AUTO	58,670.9	59,667.0	▲	1.7
HEALTHCARE	47,844.9	48,562.2	▲	1.5
BANKEX	65,072.6	65,599.6	▲	0.8
FMCG	18,414.1	18,342.5	▼	-0.4
OIL&GAS	26,478.5	26,309.8	▼	-0.6
IT	26,829.5	26,650.9	▼	-0.7
TECK	14,627.6	14,366.9	▼	-1.8
PSU	21,292.4	20,912.5	▼	-1.8
CONSUMER DURABLES	61,066.9	59,369.4	▼	-2.8
POWER	8,289.3	8,043.9	▼	-3.0
CAPITAL GOODS	83,601.0	80,938.1	▼	-3.2
METALS	42,051.2	40,065.3	▼	-4.7

How other indices moved

BANK NIFTY	57,685.8	58,177.1	▲	0.9
NIFTY 100	25,086.7	25,114.1	▲	0.1
NIFTY 500	23,144.2	23,113.7	▼	-0.1
NIFTY 200	13,911.3	13,891.3	▼	-0.1
NIFTY NEXT 50	72,356.7	72,199.6	▼	-0.2

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I belong to an industry notorious for asset turnover of around 1x, yet I still earn 15-20 per cent return on equity.
- Despite spending 20 per cent of my profits on brand building every year, I am struggling to grow, as evidenced by a 5 per cent CAGR in annual revenue over the last decade.
- My cousins, who separated from my founder family, have gone on to build a multi-billion-dollar global business and delivered 50x returns to shareholders over the last 15 years.
- While I have delivered 5x returns to shareholders in three years twice in previous business cycles, cumulative return is only 12 per cent per annum over the last 10 years.
- My founders continue to own more than two-thirds of the company, and institutional ownership is negligible.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Last week's stock: Vinati Organics
Last week's winner: Shripad Kale

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,056) and Nifty Bank (58,177) gained 0.2 per cent and 0.9 per cent respectively over the past week.

While the gains were modest, particularly in Nifty, the derivatives data indicates that the positive undertone seen over the previous fortnight remains intact. However, unlike the last two weeks, when the rally was driven largely by short covering, the latest positioning reflects rollover-related additions to the July series with a mild bullish bias.

FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) remained net short on index futures, although the position narrowed marginally from 2.26 lakh contracts to 2.24 lakh contracts. They also reduced net short positions on index call options by 13 per cent to 2.60 lakh contracts.

However, net long positions in index puts remained elevated at 5.97 lakh contracts, indicating that institutional investors continue to maintain downside protection despite the recent recovery.

At the broader level, the positioning remained mixed. Combined net short positions on index futures increased from 64,138 contracts to 72,767 contracts. On the other hand, net short positions on call options declined sharply by 22 per cent to 1.20 lakh contracts, suggesting that traders have become less aggressive in capping upside expectations. Net put shorts also moderated from 1.48 lakh contracts to 1.34 lakh contracts, pointing to a further easing in bearish conviction.

The derivatives data broadly mirrors the divergence in price action. Nifty continued to move higher but lacked strong momentum, whereas Bank Nifty extended its outperformance. Overall, the data points to a market where sentiment remains constructive, although the rollover into the July series and the absence of aggressive long additions suggest that traders are still awaiting stronger directional cues.



F&O TRACKER. Derivatives positioning remains constructive, but traders await confirmation from price action

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Jul) (24,171) remained volatile last week. After opening on a subdued note on Monday, the contract came under pressure mid-week before recovering towards the end of the week. Despite the fluctuations, Nifty futures (Jul) managed to end the week marginally higher.

The increase in price was accompanied by a sharp rise in open interest (OI), with July futures OI expanding from 24.2 lakh contracts to 91.7 lakh contracts. While a substantial part of this increase can be attributed to rollover from the expiring June series, the higher price and OI indicate a mildly positive bias in positioning.

The options data also supports a constructive outlook. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of July options stood at 1.13 at the end of last week. A PCR above 1 indicates that put writing continues to exceed call writing, reflecting a favourable sentiment among option traders.

That said, the chart shows that Nifty futures (Jul) is currently facing a resistance at 24,300. This appears to be a strong hurdle, as evidenced by the selling pressure seen on Thursday. However, if the contract breaks out of 24,300, supported by the positive undertone in derivatives positioning, it can extend the rally to 24,700.

On the downside, immediate supports are at 23,950 and 23,820,

WAITING FOR CUES

- July series sees fresh long addition
- Nifty futures faces hurdle at 24,300
- Nifty Bank futures targets 60,000

the latter coinciding with the 21-day moving average. As long as the base at 23,750 remains intact, the broader outlook will stay positive.

Strategy: Last week, we suggested buying Nifty futures (Jun) on a decline to 23,900. Since the contract is set to expire on June 30, we recommend exiting this trade now at 24,102.

For fresh positions, go long on Nifty futures (Jul) if it breaks above 24,300. Place stop-loss at 24,000. When the contract rises to 24,600, revise the stop-loss to 24,500. Book profits at 24,700.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Jul) (58,614), too, witnessed a sharp intraday decline on Tuesday. However, the contract recovered strongly thereafter, surpassed the previous week's high and ended the week with a gain of 0.7 per cent.

The rise was accompanied by a substantial increase in OI, which expanded from 3.1 lakh contracts to 12.6 lakh contracts. While a part

of this increase can be attributed to rollover from the expiring June series, the combination of higher price and OI points to a meaningful build-up of long positions. Compared to Nifty futures, the signal appears relatively stronger given Bank Nifty's superior price performance.

That said, the PCR of July options moderated slightly from 0.84 to 0.79 due to relatively higher call writing. While this reflects some caution among option traders, it does not negate the positive signals from the futures segment.

Overall, the chart continues to exhibit a bullish bias. We expect Nifty Bank futures (Jul) to resume the uptrend and move towards 60,000, a key resistance level. A breakout above 60,000 can pave the way for a rally to 61,000.

On the downside, the contract can find support at 57,500, followed by 57,000. However, given the prevailing price structure and the positive undertone in derivatives positioning, a sustained decline below 57,500 appears unlikely.

Strategy: Last week, we recommended buying Nifty Bank futures (Jun) at 57,200. Since the contract is due to expire on June 30, traders can exit this position now at 58,614. For fresh positions, consider buying Nifty Bank futures (Jul) at 58,250. Place stop-loss at 57,400 and book profits at 60,000.

Futures: Discerning signals from OI

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Because it is difficult to ascertain were the balance of power lies

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy



● WAITING FOR CUES

In futures you would not know whether the longs or the shorts have the power to nudge the index in their preferred direction

PRIMARY POSITION

If you were to combine futures and options, then the former will be your primary position. Why? Futures move nearly one-to-one with the underlying whereas options cannot. This is because options suffer from time decay, as time value must become zero at expiry. So, even as the intrinsic value of an option moves one-to-one with the underlying, the decaying time value slows down the option price in relation to the underlying movement.

Suppose you have a bullish view

on the underlying but expect a strong overhead resistance. You would go long on futures and short a call whose strike is just above the resistance level. The objective is to capture the underlying's directional movement through the nearly one-to-one movement in futures and gains from time decay through options, as you expect the option to expire out-of-the-money

Room for a rebound

BULLION CUES. Aggressive traders can go long

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



₹1,50,000. Maintain a stop-loss at ₹1,40,000 and strictly adhere to it.

MCX-Gold (₹1,44,162)

Gold futures (Aug) declined to ₹1,40,543 on Wednesday and recovered modestly. Bears remain in control, with no clear sign of a sustained uptrend. That said, a short-term corrective rebound towards ₹1,50,000 cannot be ruled out.

A breakout above ₹1,50,000 can pave the way for a rally to ₹1,54,000. However, only a decisive breach of ₹1,54,000 will turn the broader outlook bullish.

Conversely, if the contract resumes its decline from the current level of ₹1,44,162, it could slide towards ₹1,38,000.

Trade strategy: Risk-averse traders can stay on the sidelines. Aggressive traders can go long at ₹1,44,000 with a target of

Relief rally likely

CRUDE CHECK. Support zone under watch

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Crude oil prices tumbled over the last week, extending the downtrend. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$72.60/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹6,577/barrel) slumped 9.9 per cent and 9.4 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$72.60)

Brent crude oil futures fell to a four-month low of \$71.93 on Friday. The broader trend remains bearish. But, a key support is at \$71, where a rising trendline also converges.

Given this setup, there is a reasonable chance of a corrective rebound from current levels. Such a rally can take Brent futures to \$80. A breakout above this resistance can extend the up move to \$86.

However, if the contract slips below the \$71 support, it can trigger a fresh leg of decline towards \$65 and, subsequently, \$60, both important support levels.

MCX Crude Oil (₹6,577)

Crude oil futures (July) breached the support at ₹7,000 last week and

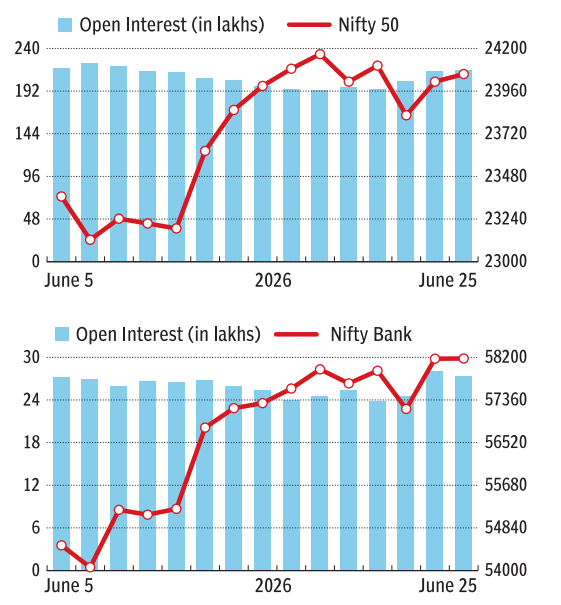
extended the decline to an intraweek low of ₹6,497 on Friday. The prevailing price structure continues to indicate a bearish bias.

That said, a rebound in Brent crude from the key support at ₹71 can provide support to MCX crude oil futures as well. In such a scenario, the contract can rise to the ₹7,200-7,300 region. A decisive breakout above this zone can pave the way for a rally to ₹8,000.

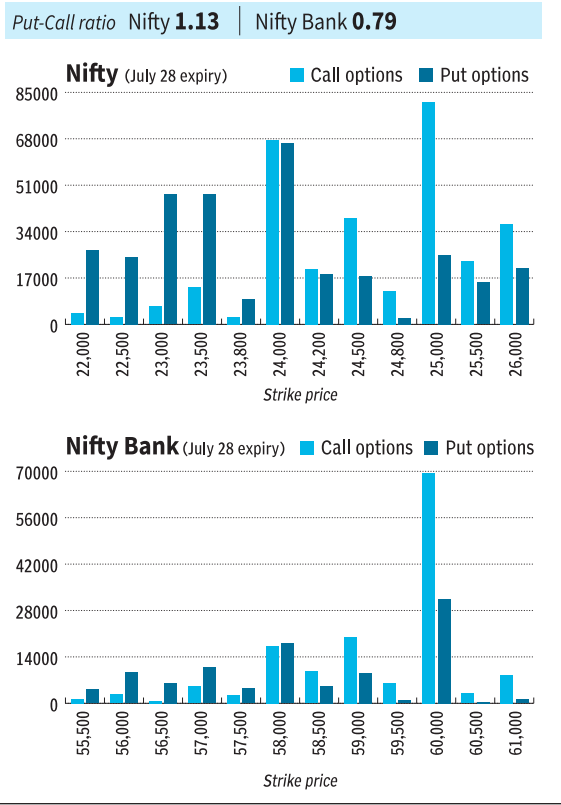
On the other hand, if the contract comes under renewed selling pressure and breaks below ₹6,400, it can resume the downtrend and decline towards ₹5,800 and then ₹5,500.

Trade strategy: Traders with a higher risk appetite can consider going long on crude oil futures at ₹6,577 with a tight stop-loss at ₹6,350. Book profits at ₹7,200.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Jun 25	Weekly change %	As on Jun 25	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	51212	29	231872	-3
Future Index Short	275021	3	80830	6
Net Futures	-223809	-1	151042	-7
Index Call options Long	655869	2	2891581	-7
Index Call options Short	915781	-3	2752062	-7
Net Call options	-259912	-13	139519	-4
Index Put options Long	1184577	2	2568557	6
Index Put options Short	587931	11	3299456	3
Net Put Options	596646	-5	-730899	-6

FIIs have marginally reduced net short on index futures. They've also reduced net short on call options and net long on put options.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Jun 25)				
IRFC	91.77	-7.8	2528.3	53.2
GVT&D	5,043.00	-8.9	30.7	40.7
VEDL	273.45	-9.1	1867.7	37.2
HEROMOTOCO	4,896.10	-1.6	115.2	33.6
DELHIVERY	464.80	0.8	557.3	32.8
FALL (as on Jun 25)				
AMBER	7,659.00	-2.9	48.9	-22.2
PATANJALI	412.55	-2.2	382.2	-16.3
SAMMAANCAP	169.81	-2.7	1153.0	-16.0
MCX	2,831.70	1.0	307.5	-13.5
GODREJCP	1,034.60	3.4	154.5	-12.6

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jul 11)

Nil

Change in OI and market positioning

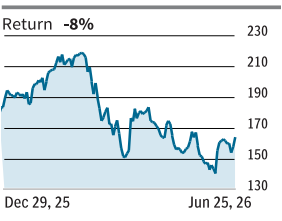
Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
		(Weekly change %)		
COMMODITIES (as on Jun 26)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Jul	332.9 (-6.3)	3,878 (77)	Short build-up
COPPER	31-Jul	1,266.7 (-4.6)	14,867 (107)	Short build-up
CRUDEOIL	20-Jul	6,577.0 (-9.4)	19,904 (124)	Short build-up
CRUDEOILM	20-Jul	6,577.0 (-9.5)	41,649 (43)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Aug	1,44,162.0 (-2.1)	10,096 (8)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	31-Jul	1,16,000.0 (-2.5)	16,973 (76)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Aug	1,44,113.0 (-2.1)	33,341 (85)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	31-Jul	14,506.0 (-2.4)	2,34,310 (78)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	31-Jul	1,44,393.0 (-2.1)	31,468 (46)	Short build-up
LEAD	31-Jul	197.7 (-3.9)	424 (71)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	28-Jul	312.9 (1.6)	18,802 (114)	Long build-up
SILVER	4-Sep	2,23,472.0 (-6.4)	10,733 (119)	Short build-up
SILVERM	31-Aug	2,27,176.0 (-6.5)	25,765 (75)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	2,27,232.0 (-6.5)	1,00,584 (84)	Short build-up
ZINC	31-Jul	358.7 (-1.4)	2,379 (107)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Jun 25)				
USDINR	29-Jul	94.7 (0)	93292 (424)	Long build-up
EURINR	29-Jul	107.71 (-)	3958 (-)	-
GBPINR	29-Jul	125.03 (-)	11197 (-)	-

F&O Strategy

Buy Ashok Leyland futures

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Ashok Leyland (₹160.68) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate support levels are at ₹148 and ₹138. A close below the latter can trigger a fall to ₹120. Nearest resistance levels are at ₹170 and ₹187. A close above the latter will reconfirm the long-term bullish. We expect the stock to sustain the recovery momentum.



F&O pointers: Ashok Leyland futures witnessed a healthy rollover of nearly 54 per cent to July contracts. The June and July contracts of Ashok Leyland closed with marginal premium at ₹161.06 and at ₹161.74 respectively against the spot price of ₹160.68. Besides, Ashok Leyland futures also witnessed a steady build-up of open interests over the last few days, signalling long rollovers. Option trading indicates that Ashok Leyland can move between ₹150 and ₹180.

Strategy: Consider going long on Ashok Leyland July futures. This strategy is strictly for traders who can understand risk and margin commitment with respect to futures trading.

Initial stop loss can be at ₹157. The stop loss can be shifted to ₹160 if the stock opens on positive note. Aim for a target of ₹167-170 with a trailing stop loss.

However, traders can stay away from this strategy if Ashok Leyland opens above ₹165 or below ₹157 on Monday. During settlement days (June 30), the stock can be volatile. Hence, risk-averse traders are advised to stay away from this strategy.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

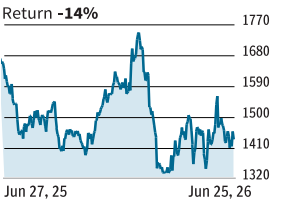
Short Take

Tech Mahindra F&O adjustments

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

On April 28, Tech Mahindra (₹1,436.65) announced an interim dividend of ₹36. The face value per equity share is ₹5. The dividend will lead to necessary adjustments in the futures and options (F&O) contracts on this stock on the record date.

The company has decided July 3 as the record/effective date. On this day, the stock price and all derivatives contracts on Tech Mahindra will be adjusted appropriately.



With respect to adjustment in futures contracts, the reference rate of the relevant contract on July 2 will be considered. Reference rate will be the mark-to-market settlement price of the relevant futures contract. So, the open positions shall be carried forward to July 3 at the daily settlement price on July 2 minus ₹36, the dividend amount.

Suppose the July expiry futures closes at ₹1,460 on July 2, it will be revised to ₹1,424 (₹1,460 minus ₹36). Hence, the contract value will come down.

Likewise, in options, all the strike prices in the option chain of Tech Mahindra will be subtracted by ₹36 from July 3. For example, the strike price of 1,460 and 1,500 will be modified to 1,424 and 1,464 respectively.

That said, the above measures are not likely to impact the overall trend of this stock. So, traders can stick to their views and are only required to note the changes in the contracts that they hold.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex held very well above their support and have seen a good bounce last week. Nifty Bank index, on the other hand, oscillated well within the expected range.

Overall, the movement in the market is happening in line with our expectation. That continues to keep intact our bullish view.

We expect the Sensex and Nifty to breach their immediate resistance and go higher in the coming weeks. Nifty Bank index can make a bullish breakout of its range and rise.

The midcap and smallcap indices underperformed last week. The Nifty Midcap 150 index fell 0.97 per cent while the Nifty Smallcap 250 index was down marginally by 0.05 per cent.

Among the sectors, the BSE Metal index, down 4.7 per cent was beaten down badly.

FPIS BUY

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) bought the Indian equities for the second consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$788 million.

Need to see if the FPIs accelerate their purchase. If that happens, then Sensex and Nifty can get a push to go higher. The FPI action in the coming weeks will need a close watch.

NIFTY 50 (24,056)

Short-term view: The support in the 23,800-23,600 region mentioned last week has held very well as expected. Nifty touched a low of 23,784.95 and has risen back very well from there. However, the resistance at 24,200 is continuing to cap the upside.

The bias remains positive. As such we can expect a breakout above 24,200. Such a break can take the Nifty higher to 24,750 or 24,850 in the short term.

The near-term picture will turn negative only on a break below 23,800. If that happens, a fall to 23,650 or even 23,450 can be seen.

Medium-term view: There is no major change in the broader bullish outlook. Nifty is currently moving up within its broad 22,000-26,500 range. A decisive break above 24,850 will take it up to 26,500

Eventually we expect a bullish breakout above 26,500. That will boost the momentum and take the Nifty up to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term. Nifty has to decline below 22,000 to prove this bullish view wrong.

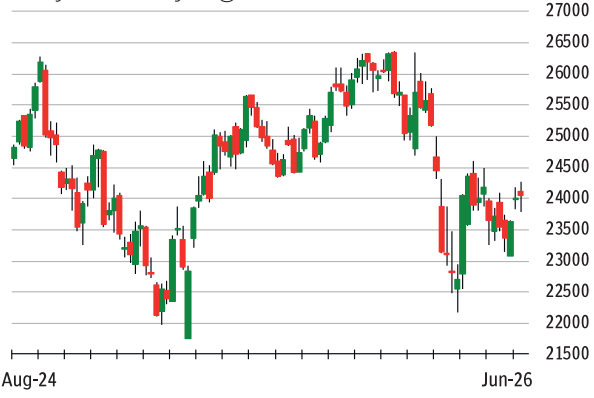
NIFTY BANK (58,117.05)

Short-term view: The view of



INDEX OUTLOOK. The benchmark indices are holding well above their support but need a trigger for fresh rally

Nifty 50: Staying afloat



seeing a range bound move between 56,500 and 58,800 is working out well. Nifty Bank index oscillated between 57,074 and 58,706 last week. The 200-Day Moving Average (DMA), currently at 57,125 has limited the downside all through last week.

That keeps intact our bullish view of seeing a breakout above 58,800. Such a break can take the Nifty Bank index up to 60,500 or 61,500 in the coming weeks.

A fall below 56,500 is needed to turn the near-term outlook negative. Only then a fall to 56,000 or 55,500 will come into the picture.

Medium-term view: The overall picture remains bullish. The region between 61,000 and 61,500 will be an important resistance area to watch.

A break above 61,500 will strengthen the bullish case for a rise to 65,000 in the medium term. It will also open the doors for the Nifty Bank index to target 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

Key supports are at 53,500 and

50,000. Ideally, the index has to decline below 50,000 to turn bearish.

SENSEX (77,100.47)

Near-term view: Sensex has risen back well from the low of 76,082.51. Immediate support is at 76,800. Below that 76,000 will continue to act as a strong support. Resistance is at 77,700. We expect the Sensex to breach this hurdle and rise to 78,800-79,000 in a week or two. An extended rise to 80,000 is also a possibility that cannot be ruled out.

Sensex has to decline below 76,000 to turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, a fall to 75,500 or even 74,000 is possible. But our preference is to see the Sensex sustaining above 76,000.

Medium-term view: The long-term bullish outlook remains intact. Sensex is now moving up within its 71,000-86,000 range. The region between 80,000 and 80,500 is a crucial intermedi-

IMMEDIATE RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 24,200
- Sensex: 77,700
- Nifty Bank: 58,800

ate resistance. A break above 80,500 will clear the way for the index to move up towards 86,000, the upper end of the range, in the medium term.

From a long-term perspective, Sensex is expected rise past 86,000 and target 90,000 and even 94,000.

The bullish view will go wrong only if the Sensex declines below 71,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,751.05)

The crucial resistance level of 23,150 has capped the upside very well. The Nifty Midcap 150 index made a high of 23,138.90 and has come down from there. Immediate support is at 22,700. A fall below it can drag the index down to 22,300 or 22,100. In that case, the 21,700-23,000 range may come back into the picture again.

On the other hand, if the index manages sustain above 22,700 and bounces back, then it will be positive. That will increase the chances of getting a bullish breakout above 23,150. Such a break will boost the momentum. It can trigger a fresh rally to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term. That will also keep the doors open for the Nifty Midcap 150 index to target 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index de-

clines below 21,700. If that happens, a fall to 21,200-21,000 can be seen.

The region between 21,000 and 20,800 is a crucial support zone. The long-term bullish view will get negated only if the index falls below 20,800. That looks less likely for now.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (17,704.70)

The price action last week indicates lack of strong follow-through buying in the market. Immediate support is around 17,550. If the index manages to sustain above this support, a rise to 18,200-18,300, the crucial resistance, is possible in the short term. A decisive break above 18,300 will strengthen the bullish case. That in turn can trigger a fresh rally towards 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-25,000 in the long term. A fall below 14,000 is needed to negate this long-term bullish view.

On the other hand, a fall below 17,550 from current levels can bring the index under pressure. In that case a fall to 17,200 or even 16,700-16,600 is possible in the short term.



Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil

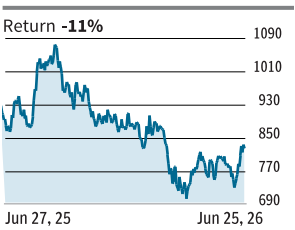


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Chalet Hotels (₹818.65)

Breaks out of resistance

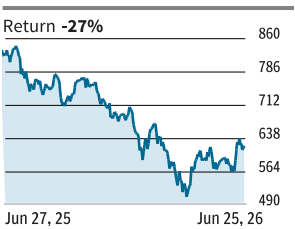


The stock of Chalet Hotels has been rallying for nearly two weeks. Early last week, it broke out of a resistance at ₹810, opening the door for further rally. While the likelihood of a price rise is high, there is a good chance for the stock to see some moderation in price before the next uptrend. The correction

can drag the price to ₹780. Given the above factors, traders can buy the stock of Chalet Hotels now at ₹818 and accumulate at ₹780 Place stop-loss at ₹710. When the stock rises to ₹900, raise the stop-loss to ₹850. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹900 when the stock hits ₹950. Liquidate the longs at ₹1,000.

DLF (₹621.60)

Surpasses a key hurdle

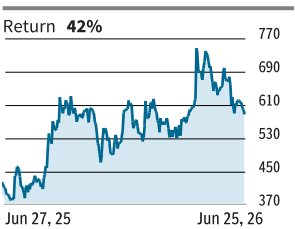


The stock reversed the trend in early April after finding the support at ₹490. In May, the scrip formed a higher base at ₹555. On the back of this, it rallied and surpassed a barrier at ₹615. Also, the price has moved above 21-day moving average. The chart shows that the outlook has turned positive but

there could be a price decline, possibly to ₹590. Participants can consider fresh longs at the current level of ₹621 and buy more shares if the price dips to ₹590. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹540. When the price goes up to ₹680, alter the stop-loss to ₹630. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹680 when the stock hits ₹720. Book profits at ₹750.

GMDC (₹585.90)

Approaching a strong support



a recovery on the back of this. Once the trend reverses, it can appreciate to retest ₹750. So, traders can go long at ₹580 and place a stop-loss at ₹550. When the price goes up to ₹640, raise the stop-loss to ₹600. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹650 when the stock hits ₹700. Book profits at ₹750. Stick to the stop-loss strictly as the breach of ₹580 can trigger a sharp decline.

Downside risk

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The US bourses look vulnerable to fall more

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average is managing to inch up every week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite on the other hand are struggling to move up. The Dow Jones was up 0.6 per cent and the S&P 500 fell 1.95 per cent last week. The NASDAQ Composite was knocked down badly by 4.6 per cent. An overall picture on the US equity market shows that the rally is fizzling out. As such, the Dow Jones can turn down any time. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index look vulnerable to fall more.

DOW JONES (51,881.18)

The price action over the last couple of weeks indicate that the index is not getting a sustained rise above 52,000. Strong resistance is in the 52,500-53,000 region. We expect the upside to be capped at 53,000 for now. As long as the index stays below 53,000, there are good chances to see a fall to 49,000 in the coming weeks. A break below the intermediate support level of 51,270 can trigger this fall.

So, if the Dow moves above 52,000, there should be more caution rather than an increased bullishness. That is, market has to be looked from the sell side rather than considering it as an opportunity to buy.

S&P 500 (7,354.03)

The index is not getting fresh buyers to take it decisively above 7,600. The outlook is negative. Cluster of resistances are there in the broad 7,430-7,500. So, there are good chances for the index to trade below 7,500 itself going forward.

S&P 500 index can fall to 7,200-7,150 in the short-term. A bounce thereafter can take it back up to 7,250-7,300.

Ideally, the index has to



● LIMITED DOWNSIDE

The dollar index has strong support in the 101-100.70 region which can hold well and push it higher again

breach 7,600 decisively to regain the bullish momentum. Only then the upside will open up to see 7,800 and higher levels. But looking at the charts, the fall to 7,150 is likely to happen first.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (25,297.62)

The short-term picture is weak. Immediate resistances are at 25,650 and 25,850. The outlook is bearish. NASDAQ Composite index can fall to 24,200-24,000 in the coming weeks. After this fall, a corrective rise to 25,000 is a possibility.

The level of 26,250 is a crucial resistance now. The index has to surpass this hurdle to bring back the bullishness. Only then a rise to 27,500-28,000 will come back into the picture again.

DOLLAR INDEX

The dollar index (101.37) has come down slightly from the

high of 101.80. The outlook is bullish. Cluster of supports are there in the 101-100.70 region which can limit the downside. Dollar index is likely to sustain above this support zone and reverse higher again. A rise to 102.80 can be seen in the short term.

From a medium-term perspective, the dollar index has potential to target 105-106 in the coming months. The prospects of a rate hike this year can support the greenback to strengthen going forward.

To negate this rise, the index has to decline below 100.70. If that happens, a fall to 99.50 can be seen.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.38 per cent) is struggling to breach its resistance at 4.55 per cent. Immediate resistance is at 4.45 per cent. Failure to rise back above this resistance can keep the yield under pressure. A fall to 4.3-4.25 per cent can be seen in that case. A fresh rise thereafter can take the 10Yr higher to 4.5 per cent again.

A sustained rise above 4.55 per cent will be bullish to see 4.8 per cent on the upside over the medium term.

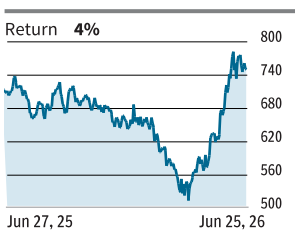
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl. research bureau

I have bought Tata Technologies shares at ₹1,030. What is the technical outlook for this stock?
Gunashekhar P, Chennai

Tata Technologies (₹747): The trend is down ever since the stock got listed in November 2023. The strong rise from the low of ₹507.50 made in March will still be a

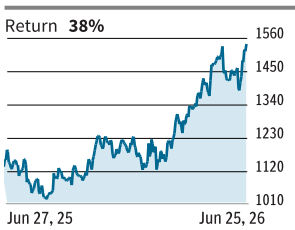


correction within the broad downtrend. Crucial resistances are at ₹770 and ₹800. A sustained rise above ₹800 is needed to confirm the bullish trend reversal. Only then upside will open up for a rise to ₹980-₹1,000 or higher. Failure to breach ₹800 can drag the price

down to ₹700-₹650. It is better to accept the loss and exit the stock. As we always insist in this column, having a stop-loss first in place is a must whenever you enter any trade. That will help in minimising the loss and avoid getting stuck in a wrong trade.

I have Aurobindo Pharma shares. My purchase price is ₹1,466. What is the outlook?
Anjali, Trivandrum

Aurobindo Pharma (₹1,554): The trend is up since January 2023. The strong rise this year marks the end of the corrective fall that was in place since September

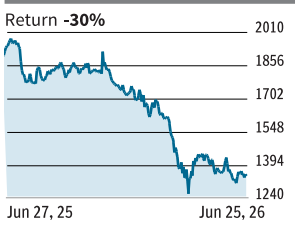


2024. The outlook is bullish. Aurobindo Pharma share price can target ₹1,730 first and then ₹1,900 eventually in the coming months. Supports are at ₹1,360 and ₹1,220. Keep a stop-loss at ₹1,320 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,560 when the price goes up to

₹1,730. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,710 and ₹1,820 when the price touches ₹1,780 and ₹1,845 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,880. The stock has to decline below ₹1,250 to prove this bullish view wrong. If that happens, adhere to the stop-loss and exit.

I bought ACC shares at ₹2,316 as a long-term investment. What should I do now?
V Subbarao, Mumbai

ACC (₹1,336): The trend is down. A crucial long-term support is at ₹1,170. A strong bounce from there can take the price up to ₹1,700-₹1,750 in the next six

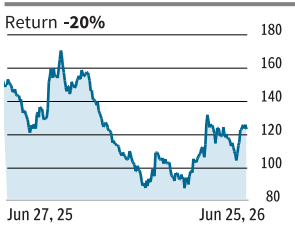


months. A sustained rise above ₹1,750 will only confirm a bullish trend reversal and trigger a fresh rally to ₹2,250 and even ₹3,000 over the next two years. If you have the risk appetite, then accumulate at ₹1,220. Keep the stop-loss at ₹910. Move it up to ₹1,320 when the price

goes up to ₹1,580. Exit 30 per cent of your holding at ₹1,720 and move the stop-loss up to ₹1,580 for the remaining. When the price goes up to ₹1,880, move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,760. Thereafter for every rise by ₹200, move the stop-loss by ₹100. Exit the stock at ₹2,980.

What is the long-term outlook for Electronics Mart India Limited (EMIL). My purchase price is ₹120.
Rimika, Kolkata

EMIL (₹120): The stock is in a downtrend since July 2024. The recent price action indicates an early sign of a trend reversal. Important support is in the ₹105-₹100



region. Resistance is around ₹140. A decisive break above this resistance will confirm the trend reversal. That will be bullish to see a rise to ₹190-₹200 going forward. Keep the stop-loss at ₹94 and hold the stock. You can also consider buying more if a dip to ₹110 happens

first. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹125 when the price goes up to ₹137. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹145 and ₹175 when the price touches ₹160 and ₹190 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹200. A decisive break above ₹200 is needed to revisit ₹250 levels.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all!" So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS	These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner Md Nijam
	1 InterGlobe Aviation	Last week's winning stock Kirloskar Brothers
	2 PVR Inox	Closing price (June 19) ₹1,938.45
	3 TVS Motor Company	Closing price (June 25) ₹2,017.05
	4 HDB Financial Services	Return: 4.05 per cent
	5 Ashok Leyland	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Take 500

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.4 and 0.2 per cent respectively last week. BSE Realty and BSE Auto gained the most by 1.7 per cent each, followed by BSE Healthcare 1.5 per cent. BSE Metal and BSE Capital Goods declined by 4.7 and 3.2 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Tech
P/E	20.8	20.9	36.6	14.8	56.8	65.3	33.4	42.9	18.6	18.2	8.3	36.3	11.2	39.1	19.9
P/BV	3.2	4.1	7.2	2.4	15.7	16.3	7.6	7.5	5.5	3.1	1.6	5.3	2.3	5.2	7.4
Dividend Yield	1.4	1.3	1.1	1.0	0.4	0.5	0.9	0.5	2.5	0.5	3.1	1.0	2.1	0.4	1.9
Weekly Return (%)	0.2 ▲	0.4 ▲	1.7 ▲	0.8 ▲	-3.2 ▼	-2.8 ▼	-0.4 ▼	1.5 ▲	-0.7 ▼	-4.7 ▼	-0.6 ▼	-3.0 ▼	-1.8 ▼	1.7 ▲	-1.8 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	0.1 ▲	0.8 ▲	2.3 ▲	5.3 ▲	2.8 ▲	1.5 ▲	-1.1 ▼	2.3 ▲	-5.3 ▼	-8.1 ▼	-4.4 ▼	-1.4 ▼	-1.7 ▼	5.2 ▲	-4.3 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-4.7 ▼	-6.8 ▼	11.9 ▲	3.0 ▲	14.5 ▲	0.9 ▲	-8.9 ▼	11.4 ▲	-30.2 ▼	29.1 ▲	-2.8 ▼	18.7 ▲	6.9 ▲	-18.5 ▼	-23.0 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
---------	-----	-----	----	----	----------	-----------	------------	-----------	------------	----------	------	-----	---------	--------

3M One [1]	1083.6	29.9	36.2	4.5	202603	35.9	15.7	39.9	12.9	-5.5	14.3	2.0	1273.0	906.2
360 India [1]	3392.4	542.7	61.5	17.5	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	0.8	39.8	0.0	3830.0	2840.0

A B B [2]	6994.1	71.9	97.3	18.9	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-3.5	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	97.8	1.7	57.2	8.5	202603	-11.9	-57.7	7.2	-29.4	0.7	11.7	2.3	167.9	87.1
A B Real Estate [1]	1347.8	-27.0	4.1	202603	-79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-60.4	5.6	-0.2	1.0	2460.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [1]	518.6	25.3	20.4	3.0	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	0.2	11.4	2.8	547.8	425.1
Aarti Industries [5]	465.7	11.4	4.0	2.8	202603	13.1	42.7	14.1	25.2	3.9	6.2	0.7	522.9	338.0
AAVAS Financiers [1]	1486.6	61.9	24.1	3.1	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	1.1	9.9	2.2	2152.0	1050.3
Abbott India [1]	25591.0	730.4	35.0	11.4	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	-2.4	5.0	0.3	99261.625164	0.4
ACC [1]	1338.7	112.4	11.9	1.2	202603	16.9	62.9	17.3	-9.0	-4.0	11.2	0.0	2027.8	1250.9
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	356.9	1.1	50.2	3.2	202603	12.5	0.0	1.1	25.2	-3.9	0.6	1.0	366.3	25.0
Action Const.Eng. [1]	989.3	34.9	28.4	5.9	202603	7.1	-6.5	-1.4	1.5	40.2	0.0	1.0	1235.0	104.0
Acutaeas Chemical [5]	3297.5	43.5	75.8	16.3	202603	4.0	110.9	33.0	124.5	1.6	20.1	0.1	3424.2	1056.1
Adani Energy Sol. [1]	1509.8	19.0	79.5	7.1	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	-0.2	9.5	1.9	1614.4	745.5
Adani Enterp. [1]	1526.6	16.7	181.7	10.3	202603	20.3	-124.0	-2.6	-48.0	0.0	5.6	1.5	3104.8	1735.5
Adani Green [1]	1526.6	15.2	136.1	13.0	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.1	0.7	8.0	1.5	1562.7	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1796.3	56.3	31.9	4.3	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	-2.1	33.8	0.7	1857.6	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	229.3	6.7	34.4	7.1	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-0.1	16.6	0.8	254.2	109.8
Adani Total Gas [1]	719.4	6.0	120.7	16.3	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-1.3	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
AIRTEL HVC [5]	133.0	33.8	3.7	8.2	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	-3.5	35.5	0.0	1224.8	708.0
Aditya Bk. Fns. [1]	60.0	-6.1	1.3	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-1.4	0.0	1.3	95.0	53.6	
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	390.5	13.9	28.1	2.8	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	-3.9	9.5	4.4	399.4	244.0
Aditya Infotech [1]	3558.1	31.2	114.0	22.3	202603	45.5	20.7	35.6	100.5	-2.2	19.3	0.6	3738.1	1014.7
Aegis Logistics [1]	1140.5	25.6	44.6	6.6	202603	5.2	45.7	23.2	35.4	13.1	14.5	0.9	1154.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term. [1]	233.6	2.3	102.5	6.0	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	-2.1	7.0	2.5	302.0	158.8
Aether Industri. [1]	1325.1	17.0	77.7	7.2	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	14.1	9.7	0.1	1371.3	723.2
Aikons Infrastr. [1]	319.4	8.5	37.7	2.2	202603	-18.9	-179.7	-4.8	-36.0	-1.4	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.5
Airtel Payments [1]	1494.8	21.3	44.9	3.9	202603	15.7	26.0	25.2	15.5	-0.1	0.1	2186.0	121.9	1.0
AIA Engineering [2]	4836.8	136.4	35.5	5.6	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	19.9	1.5	19.1	0.1	5059.8	3006.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3137.9	84.5	37.6	8.8	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	3.8	31.8	0.0	3314.8	2335.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5421.7	201.8	26.9	4.7	202603	14.6	3.6	13.5	11.4	0.9	20.0	0.1	5933.0	3164.0
ALLBlenders [2]	622.1	12.8	75.5	10.7	202603	9.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	-1.3	18.3	0.6	720.0	38.2
Allok Industries [1]	12.8	-1.6	-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	-3.4	0.0	0.0	23.5	11.1	
Amar Raja Ener. [1]	834.8	38.5	21.7	1.9	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	-1.1	15.6	0.0	1058.0	671.0
Amber Enterp. [1]	7660.7	57.1	134.2	6.2	202603	10.5	-26.8	12.2	-17.3	-2.9	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Amulja Cements [2]	423.6	20.0	21.1	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	-0.1	6.7	0.0	626.0	394.0
Anand Rathi Wea. [1]	1932.2	23.8	81.1	32.1	202603	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	3.4	56.8	0.1	1991.7	1011.7
Anant Raj [2]	522.5	15.4	33.9	3.3	202603	19.6	23.6	21.9	30.4	0.5	10.9	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	335.2	10.0	33.5	5.0	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-5.3	14.8	0.1	360.2	208.9
Angel Biotech [1]	1601.9	24.9	64.3	11.9	202603	26.6	3.7	23.3	21.8	-1.6	32.6	0.1	17174.0	6800.0
APAR Inds. [1]	1794.7	43.3	41.4	9.4	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-4.0	22.0	0.2	2300.0	1493.0
APAR Apollo Tubes [2]	8593.3	136.0	63.2	13.0	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	35.3	1.1	17.5	0.6	8692.0	6860.0
Apollo Hospitals [1]	190.5	33.6	12.8	1.6	202603	14.2	254.7	10.0	72.5	1.1	10.9	0.3	540.3	365.4
Apollo Tyres [1]	149.8	2.3	44.9	3.9	202603	1.5	15.1	0.5	15.6	0.5	1.5	0.5	364.3	193.5
Apurva Value Hold. [2]	898.1	13.9	64.8	5.8	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	1.7	6.1	13.1	0.9	1073.0	691.1
Asahi India Glas [1]	109.7	6.4	25.3	6.6	202603	17.1	9.0	15.9	20.9	2.6	4.9	0.3	215.4	110.0
Ashok Leyland [1]	216.2	46.3	57.2	11.3	202603	15.2	19.7	12.0	14.3	-0.4	1.2	0.0	286.5	216.0
Ashtor Value Hold. [1]	758.4	1.9	38.4	9.4	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	-0.0	11.6	0.5	848.0	518.9
Aster DM Health. [1]	1486.3	20.6	72.2	9.8	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	5.6	-3.5	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1262.8
Astral [1]	998.2	13.4	74.4	14.9	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	2.7	0.0	1.1	1068.8	318.0
Atul [1]	6673.4	230.3	29.0	3.2	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-2.8	12.8	0.0	7793.0	5563.0
Avanti Finance [1]	1555.0	61.1	25.4	2.4	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	1.8	3.8	14.2	0.2	1564.7	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	518.6	22.7	22.8	3.0	202603	-78.6	-96.6	-43.0	-54.5	-4.7	29.7	0.1	683.5	40.0
Avenue Super. [1]	4294.5	45.5	94.3	11.5	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	0.2	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
Axis Bank [1]	1564.5	19.9	34.7	8.6	202603	15.3	25.5	15.5	15.5	-0.1	1.0	0.0	1564.5	15.5
Axis Bank [2]	137.6	8.4	16.2	2.0	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	1.4	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3

B HEL [2]	402.4	4.6	87.6	5.4	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	-2.8	3.2	0.4	424.9	205.2
BPCL [1]	309.9	60.3	5.1	1.3	202603	6.7	26.1	3.4	92.1	-1.1	15.7	0.7	31.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	9842.0	385.4	25.5	7.1	202603	4.0	101.6	22.6	47.1	-2.2	28.4	0.4	10835.0	7879.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	979.9	30.8	31.8	5.4	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	-1.9	11.4	0.8	1075.0	12.3
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1764.2	62.9	28.1	3.6	202603	5.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	-0.1	12.4	4.9	2194.7	158.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10603.2	736.5	14.4	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	-0.7	11.5	0.1	10473.5	8597.5
Bajaj Housing [1]	87.5	3.1	28.4	3.2	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-1.1	9.5	4.7	124.1	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2235.7	64.4	34.8	4.0	202603	6.6	18.7	3.6	24.9	-0.4	17.9	0.3	2026.0	1971.5
Bank of Baroda [1]	533.2	17.9	29.8	2.5	202603	6.7	-30.4	15.8	-13.4	0.3	11.1	0.6	627.0	372.7
Bank of India [1]	201.8	7.6	26.6	1.3	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	-3.0	0.0	0.0	218.4	134.3
Bank of Maharashtra [1]	279.3	38.4	7.3	0.9	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	-0.6	0.0	0.0	325.6	231.0
Bank of Nepal [1]	144.7	23.5	6.2	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	-1.3	0.0	0.0	178.5	109.0
Bank of Oman [1]	88.7	9.1	9.7	2.2	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	-1.5	0.0	0.0	91.2	5.1
Banka India [1]	71.9	12.8	55.7	5.8	202603	5.0	-58.6	0.8	-29.1	-4.3	14.6	0.9	128.7	60.5
Bank of China [1]	4185.4	153.4	27.3	6.3	202603	5.2	13.1	3.7	21.3	-2.1	23.8	0.0	4600.0	4150.0
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	245.3	5.6	43.6	4.2	202603	12.2	17.5	14.7	40.8	2.1	14.1	1.1	252.0	98.6
BELM Ltd. [1]	1748.8	17.0	103.0	5.0	202603	8.6	-37.5	8.2	-51.7	-0.0	11.7	0.1	2365.0	1361.0
Bharat Electronics [1]	538.3	10.0	53.8	9.1	202603	6.1	17.3	2.9	-1.2	-2.4	24.8	0.1	604.6	39.1
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1367.9	11.5	119.3	11.8	202603	-72.9	-58.5	-27.3	-23.5	-0.4	10.2	0.0	2013.6	1090.1
Bharat Electric [1]	406.8	8.3	49.1	12.4	202603	11.7	4.6	16.2	13.9	-4.8	36.9	0.1	473.3	361.0
Bharti Group [2]	2145.1	24.6	87.3	10.3	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	13.8	5.0	11.7	0.9	2167.5	1100.0
Bharti Networks [1]	1480.2	38.2	38.6	10.3	202603	-12.0	-3.1	1.4	1.4	0.0	16.5	1.5	1480.2	38.2
Bharti Telecom [1]	1480.2	35.1	42.1	10.3	202603	5.4	9.4	9.4	35.6	0.9	16.5	1.5	2050.1	140.1
Bikaaji Foods [1]	640.7	10.4	61.5	10.0	202603	19.0	26.1	15.1	30.2	-3.3	18.4	0.2	820.9	59.1
Billionaires [2]	199.7	3.3	60.1	13.0	202603	87.9	122.1	19.0	14.2	-0.2	61.6	0.1	227.0	112.0
Birla Group [2]	415.8	1.8	108.9	2.0	202603	4.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	0.0	44.0	0.3	331.0	33.1
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	300.8	19.4	15.5	2.0	202603	2.4	44.1	-1.2	4.9	-7.8	20.8	0.0	473.8	30.0
BIS International [1]	258.9	16.7	15.5	4.3	202603	17.6	31.6	36.7	35.1	-3.2	39.0	0.1	415.0	218.0
Blue Bird Express [2]	4974.6	119.9	41.5	6.6	202603	8.2	-11.3	7.4	12.7	0.1	17.1	0.7	4079.9	4263.0
Blue Bird Transport [2]	4974.6	119.9	41.5	6.6	202603	8.2	-11.3	7.4	12.7	0.1	17.1	0.7	4079.9	4263.0
Bosch [1]	40512.6	789.4	51.3	8.0	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	0.7	20.5	0.4	10184.0	3650.0
Brainerds Soluit. [2]	223.0	-2.5	2.4	202603	120	-123.1	11.6	10.2	3.3	0.0	0.4	438.7	20.7	
Bridgeport Enginer. [2]	525.3	20.1	26.5	5.5	202603	-0.2	-42.1	12.3	44.7	3.7	13.3	1.2	488.1	46.0
Broadcom [1]	415.8	1.8	108.9	2.0	202603	4.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	0.0	44.0	0.3	331.0	33.1
Bush [1]	40512.6	789.4	51.3	8.0	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	0.7	20.5	0.4	10184.0	3650.0
Bushnell [1]	40512.6	789.4	51.3	8.0	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	0.7	20.5	0.4	10184.0	3650.0

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

India's mutual fund industry has a new version of target-date investing. In February 2026, SEBI introduced Life Cycle Funds (LCFs), replacing the earlier retirement and children's solution-oriented schemes. The category has started moving, with Zerodha Mutual Fund launching the first LCF NFOs and ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund filing draft documents for three schemes.

But are LCFs a genuine innovation for goal-based investing, or just another mutual fund category? Here is a closer look.

ASSET REBALANCING

LCFs are open-ended mutual fund schemes with a predefined target maturity year. AMCs can launch schemes maturing in 5, 10, 15, 20, 25 and 30 years, with a maximum of six active schemes open for subscription at any point. Each scheme must mention its maturity year in its name. Investors can enter and exit at any time.

The key feature is the glide path. Unlike Target Maturity Funds, whose portfolios remain largely static until maturity, LCFs gradually reduce equity allocation and increase debt allocation as the target year approaches. Investors do not have to decide when to shift from equity to debt.

For instance, an LCF maturing in 2051 could start with 65-95 per cent equity. In the final year before maturity, equity exposure may fall to 5-20 per cent, making debt the dominant asset class. SEBI has prescribed allocation bands for every stage of the fund's life.

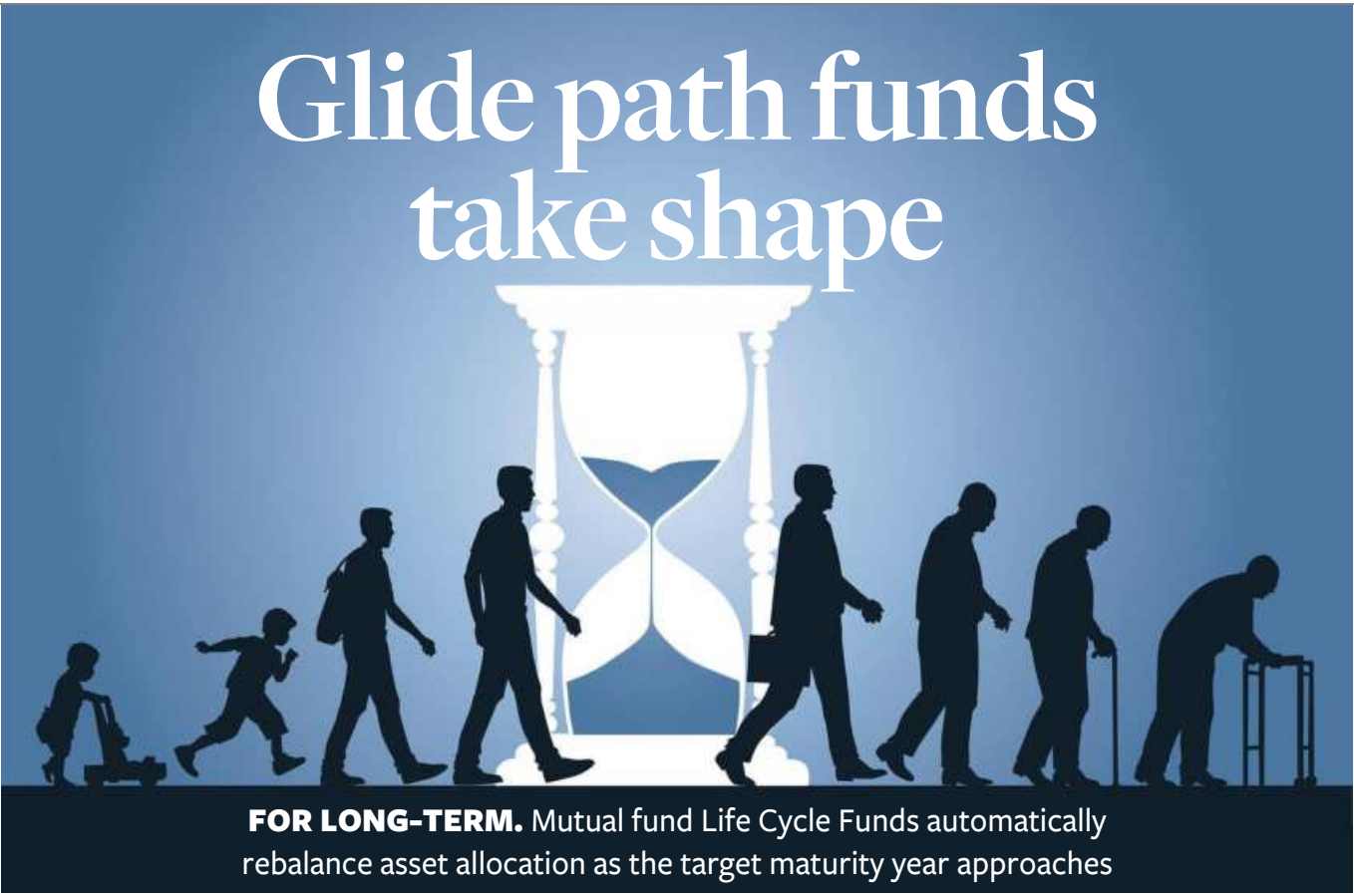
This addresses a common behavioural problem. Many investors stay overexposed to equities near retirement or other goals. Others move to debt too early and hurt long-term returns. LCFs embed disciplined asset allocation within the product.

MEASURED CHOICES

LCFs can invest in equity, debt, InvITs, exchange-traded commodity derivatives, and Gold and Silver ETFs. Early products suggest a measured approach. Zerodha proposes to use stocks from the top 250 companies in the AMFI market-cap classification. ICICI Prudential proposes to use the Nifty 200 universe.

On the debt side, fund managers can invest in government securities, corporate bonds and money market instruments. Once a scheme has less than five years to maturity, debt investments must be restricted to AA-rated and above securities, with maturities shorter than the scheme's target maturity. This reduces credit risk and interest-rate risk near the goal date.

Exposure to Gold ETFs, Silver ETFs, exchange-traded commodity derivatives and InvITs is capped at 10 per cent throughout the fund's life. Commodity deriv-

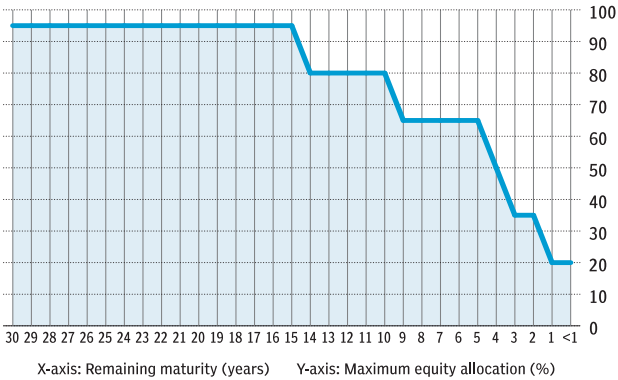


FOR LONG-TERM. Mutual fund Life Cycle Funds automatically rebalance asset allocation as the target maturity year approaches

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Life cycle funds: The built-in de-risking journey

Equity exposure declines as maturity nears



Note: Debt allocation rises as equity exposure declines. Actual allocation may vary within SEBI's prescribed asset-allocation bands

atives are allowed only for gold and silver. Alternative assets remain modest, while equity and debt remain the core drivers.

EQUITY TAXATION

Under SEBI's framework, an LCF's net equity allocation falls below 65 per cent when the remaining maturity is less than five years. This could affect equity tax status. To address this, SEBI allows fund managers to allocate up to 50 per cent to arbitrage while keeping overall equity exposure within the mandated 65-75 per cent range. This helps retain equity taxation while lowering market risk in the final years.

SEBI has prescribed a graded exit load: 3 per cent if units are redeemed within one year, 2 per cent within two years, and 1 per cent within three years. This is steeper than most mutual fund schemes and is meant to discourage short-term use.

The main benefit is simplicity. LCFs remove the recurring decision of when to move from equity to debt. The portfolio becomes more conservative as the

target year nears, reducing the need for investors to monitor markets or rebalance manually. Investors can choose a fund matching their horizon, invest through SIPs and leave asset allocation to the fund manager.

MF VERSUS NPS

The idea is not new to Indian retirement investing. The National Pension System has used a life-cycle approach for years through its Auto Choice option. Equity exposure falls with age, while corporate bond and government securities exposure rises. The newer Retirement Income Scheme under NPS also follows a glide path.

The difference is important. In NPS, the glide path is linked to the subscriber's age and is applied individually. In mutual fund LCFs, it is scheme-based. Every investor in a target-year fund follows the same allocation path until maturity. NPS is mainly a retirement product with long lock-ins and limited liquidity. LCFs are open-ended and can be used for retirement, education or other long-term goals.

CORE FEATURES

- Automatic equity-to-debt glide path
- Target-year based investment strategy
- Open-ended with equity tax advantage

LIMITATIONS

LCFs are not a one-size-fits-all solution. Investors have different incomes, responsibilities, risk appetites and existing portfolios. Yet everyone in a scheme follows the same glide path.

The funds may also become too conservative for some investors. With retirement periods now lasting 25-30 years, a sharp reduction in equity near retirement may reduce market risk but also limit inflation-beating returns. Investors who want to change allocation based on market conditions or personal circumstances may also find the glide path restrictive.

Unlike NPS, LCFs do not offer any additional tax deduction. Tax treatment will depend on each scheme's structure. Many AMCs may opt for equity-oriented funds, while others may choose debt-oriented or non-equity, non-debt structures, especially for shorter-duration schemes. Post-tax returns will therefore matter.

NFO DETAILS

Zerodha Mutual Fund has become the first AMC to launch LCF NFOs. It is offering Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2036 and Zerodha Life Cycle Fund 2041. The NFOs close on July 7, 2026. It has also sought SEBI approval for LCFs maturing in 2031, 2046 and 2051.

The schemes will invest in stocks from the Nifty LargeMid-cap 250 Index, with equal alloca-

tion to large-cap and mid-cap stocks. Debt allocation will be restricted to government securities. The schemes are equity-oriented and will use arbitrage, where needed, to retain equity tax status.

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has filed Scheme Information Documents with SEBI for LCFs maturing in 2031, 2036 and 2041. The equity portfolio is proposed to be built from the Nifty 200 universe. Like Zerodha, the schemes can use arbitrage exposure of up to 50 per cent to preserve equity-oriented tax status.

SUITABILITY

LCFs are best suited for first-time investors building a retirement corpus, SIP investors seeking a set-and-forget approach, and investors pursuing long-term goals who do not want to rebalance regularly. They may be less suitable for sophisticated investors with disciplined asset-allocation strategies, high-net-worth investors with complex needs, or those who want greater control over equity and debt allocation.

LCFs are a meaningful mutual fund innovation. But investors should not assume that automatic allocation will automatically deliver better outcomes. The category's success will depend on whether the glide paths work across market cycles and whether investors understand that convenience does not remove investment risk.

For investors who struggle with disciplined asset allocation, LCFs can be a useful long-term vehicle. But outcomes will depend on fund management quality, glide-path design, costs and investor discipline. Expense ratios are expected to be similar to hybrid funds, with the maximum permissible base total expense ratio capped at 2.1 per cent.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Jun 18
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.7	6.25	6	Jun 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.8	6.75	6.05	Jun 05
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.65	6.1	6	Jun 01
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Jun 25
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Jun 01
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	7.1	6.5	7.25	Jun 01
Federal Bank	6	6.8	6.75	6.4	Jun 03
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Jun 26
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.35	7.35	6.75	Jun 10
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jun 01
J & K Bank	6	6.8	7.3	6.7	Jun 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Jun 10
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
AU Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.4	7	Jun 10
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	7.75	6	Jun 18
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Jun 23
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05

Data as on respective banks' website on 26 Jun 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

PFRDA Pension Sahayak launched

The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) said it has launched PFRDA Pension Sahayak, an AI-enabled grievance redressal platform, designed to provide subscribers of the pension schemes regulated by PFRDA with a simple, accessible and transparent mechanism for grievance resolution. PFRDA Pension Sahayak replaces the earlier Central Grievance Management System (CGMS).

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme	Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit	1 year	4.0	Annually
	2 year	6.9	Quarterly
	3 year	7.0	Quarterly
	5 year	7.1	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)	6.7	7.5	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme	8.2	6.7	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme	7.4	8.2	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate	7.7	7.4	Annually
Public Provident Fund	7.1	7.7	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra	7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana	8.2	7.1	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026. #Will mature in 15 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

SIMPLYPUT.

AI-flation

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan

Dad and daughter get into a conversation on AI-flation

Abhi: Dad, remember the MacBook Air you promised to get me? Well, guess what. Its price just went up by \$200! If only you had bought it for me earlier without arguing...

Raghu: Hey relax, take a breath. Tell me what happened.

Abhi: You know, the MacBook variant I wanted to get, it used to cost \$1,099 before. Last week Apple increased its price to \$1,299!

Raghu: That's substantial! About 20 per cent, isn't it?

Abhi: Yeah. Apple didn't just stop with the MacBooks. They have hiked prices of pretty much everything they sell, including your favourite iPad. But interestingly, they have spared the iPhones.

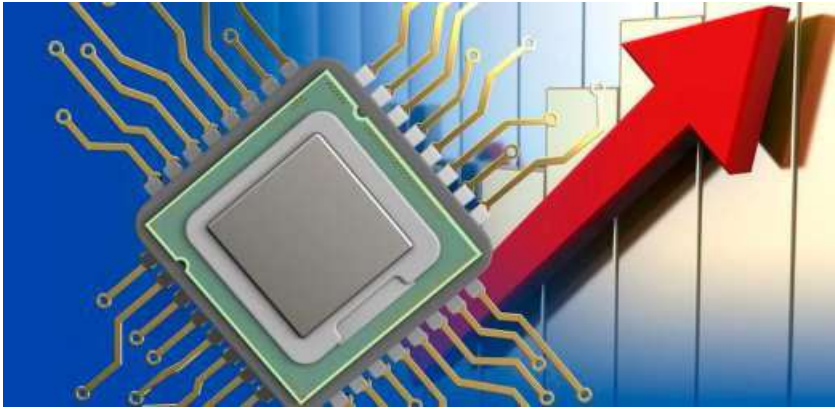
Raghu: Why the sudden move?

Abhi: Thank AI! Let me explain. Apple is increasing prices because price of memory chips have been rising exponentially for over a year now. Specifically, chips like RAM and NAND flash memory. These are found in smartphones, cameras, PCs, smart TVs, gaming consoles and car infotainment systems. Apple stated that they had never seen a component's price increase so much that they wouldn't be able to shield consumers from this inflation anymore.

Why are memory prices up, you ask? There is a massive buildup of AI data centres happening now and these data centres need vast quantities of memory chips to run. Demand for these chips has skyrocketed and the supply is nowhere close to meeting this level of demand. Hence the inflation.

Raghu: Wow! Is it that bad?

Abhi: You bet. Memory chip suppliers are scrambling to meet this demand —



often diverting consumer chip manufacturing capacity towards AI chips, as they are getting better prices there.

Sample this. Memory giant Micron reported its latest quarterly earnings last Wednesday. Average selling price (ASP) of their DRAM chips went up a whopping 60 per cent plus for the quarter ended May 2026 versus that for the quarter ended February 2026. ASP of NAND chips grew 80 per cent plus in the same period. Micron's gross margin which was 39 per cent a year ago is now twice at 85 per cent. Silicon Valley powered by Wall Street seems to be ready to blindly pay whatever is demanded for these chips, to stay ahead in the AI race.

Raghu: This feels like a UNO reverse of what happened after Covid. People started working from home and they needed all kinds of digital implements from laptops to headphones. Manufacturers diverted capacity towards consumer chips, causing a deficit of industrial chips.

Abhi: Exactly. The economists at St. Louis Fed, USA, did a study. They observed that industries that use semiconductors as a direct input account for about 40 per cent of all manufacturing output. In July 2021, they found that

while prices of output of industries that do not depend on semiconductors rose by about 9 per cent, those of the output of industries that depend on semiconductors rose higher by about 13 per cent.

Raghu: I guess the automotive industry would have been one of the prime casualties. Remember how we had to shell out more when we bought our car?

Abhi: Of course. Cars these days, use semiconductors and the auto industry was one of the most impacted ones then. New car supply was severely constrained because of this chip shortage. I remember reading about how used car prices in the US climbed about 30 per cent in May 2021, accounting for about one-third of the overall monthly CPI increase.

You are right drawing parallels with post-Covid times. But there is a difference. While the post-Covid inflation was to some extent a supply side problem — in the sense that, manufacturing was hindered by lockdowns, the inflation we are seeing now is purely a demand side problem — too much money chasing too few chips.

Raghu: Hmm... If that's the case, will prices of anything that uses a memory

chip go up? I was just about to make peace with crude oil-led inflation.

Abhi: It's likely dad. Social media has even come up with a cool name for this phenomenon — 'AI-flation'. Personal computers have already seen prices inflate. Walking Apple's path, Microsoft hiked the XBOX's price. If cloud providers eventually pass on the inflation, all services that use the cloud may become expensive.

But objectively speaking, AI-flation may not directly have a material impact on the overall retail inflation index. In India, the 'information and communication equipment and services' cohort just accounts for about 3 per cent of the CPI basket, while a similar cohort in the US constitutes 3.2 per cent of urban CPI basket. However, it remains to be seen if there will be an indirect or second order impact on the overall index — like how chip shortage affected CPI through used car prices in 2021.

Raghu: I see.

Abhi: That's not all, dad. What we must not forget here is the wealth effect. Investors and employees of AI and chip companies are becoming richer by the day. Stocks are at elevated valuations. Think SpaceX, Micron investors. Reports suggest that a Samsung memory chip worker with a base salary of \$53,000 is expected to receive a bonus worth \$416,000 as part of an AI profit-sharing deal. As this new wealth finds its way into spending, it can stoke demand, likely resulting in inflation in their respective economies.

In my view, it's too soon to conclude whether to take AI-flation seriously or to dismiss it altogether. But it's certainly interesting to watch this space.

Raghu: Makes sense. You know what? Forget the price hike and order the MacBook. Consider it my contribution to AI-flation — and a small 'thank you' for teaching me something today.



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.2	16323	1.4	0.5	-3.7	11.5	9.9	13.6	0.27
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	108.4	76297	1.1	0.7	-1.7	14.2	13.2	14.0	0.42
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	90.0	51660	1.2	0.6	-0.9	14.5	15.1	14.6	0.47
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1119.5	37808	1.5	1.0	-1.8	11.9	12.2	13.0	0.35
*****	JM Large Cap	151.1	416	2.1	0.8	-1.8	12.2	11.3	11.0	0.31
*****	Kotak Large Cap	562.3	10516	1.8	0.7	-2.0	12.1	10.5	12.4	0.29
*****	SBI Large Cap	94.4	53527	1.2	0.7	2.0	11.5	11.2	12.3	0.33
*****	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	512.0	28640	1.4	0.8	-3.5	11.6	10.8	12.0	0.30
***	Bandhan Large Cap	76.9	2001	1.8	0.8	0.2	13.5	11.5	12.7	0.32
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	217.5	2550	1.7	0.7	-1.9	12.9	11.3	12.6	0.33
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	82.1	1422	1.8	0.6	-2.8	10.9	10.6	12.6	0.30
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1001.6	7145	1.5	0.9	-2.9	11.4	8.8	10.7	0.23
***	Invesco India Largecap	70.7	1749	1.8	0.7	0.9	14.6	12.6	12.9	0.34
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	111.2	37692	1.3	0.5	-1.3	10.4	9.2	12.9	0.25
***	Tata Large Cap	505.2	2682	1.7	0.8	0.4	12.2	11.0	12.0	0.32
***	UTI Large Cap	261.3	11853	1.9	1.1	-5.3	9.1	8.2	11.4	0.21
**	DSP Large Cap	459.2	7175	1.5	0.7	-3.7	13.7	10.7	11.5	0.32
**	HSBC Large Cap	471.9	1758	1.8	1.0	-0.1	11.9	10.0	12.3	0.25
**	LIC MF Large Cap	53.3	1330	1.8	0.9	-5.6	8.9	7.6	10.5	0.18
**	Union Largecap	23.1	436	2.1	1.3	-2.2	10.0	9.1	-	0.24
**	Axis Large Cap	59.3	30005	1.3	0.6	-2.5	10.0	7.1	12.0	0.14
*	Groww Largecap	42.8	129	2.4	1.1	-0.3	11.8	10.0	11.2	0.26
*	PGIM India Large Cap	329.2	535	2.5	0.9	-3.8	8.1	7.1	10.2	0.16
-	Mah Manu Large Cap	22.1	687	2.0	0.6	-5.4	10.4	9.0	-	0.23
-	Taurus Large Cap	155.6	51	2.1	1.9	-0.9	13.0	10.1	10.1	0.26
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	139.0	17461	1.4	0.4	4.7	21.0	17.0	15.8	0.51
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	342.5	28515	1.6	0.9	0.4	16.4	15.7	14.9	0.46
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1014.9	30147	1.4	0.7	1.5	17.9	17.3	15.6	0.58
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.1	15879	1.4	0.6	4.8	15.5	13.4	-	0.36
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	124.0	3424	1.7	0.6	6.4	18.2	16.2	15.7	0.43
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	646.2	39424	1.3	0.6	5.3	15.2	14.4	15.2	0.45
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	183.3	5964	1.8	1.0	1.6	18.5	15.3	14.3	0.48
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	92.1	473	2.1	1.0	4.5	15.7	12.9	13.1	0.36
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	250.9	24490	1.4	0.5	-3.0	13.8	11.6	15.2	0.32
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	621.8	17370	1.4	0.5	0.3	17.3	13.3	15.1	0.39
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	88.9	4557	1.6	0.4	1.9	15.8	13.6	14.8	0.39
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	107.5	10153	1.5	0.5	6.7	24.0	17.6	16.7	0.46
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	348.6	30127	1.6	0.6	2.8	15.9	14.3	15.5	0.41
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	154.5	42792	1.3	0.5	3.0	14.9	12.0	16.8	0.33
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1485.4	7233	1.5	1.0	1.8	17.9	15.2	13.3	0.45
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	187.1	3392	1.7	1.1	-3.9	13.8	10.7	11.6	0.30
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	38.6	2983	1.7	0.6	-1.8	15.6	12.6	14.8	0.35
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	88.9	6690	1.8	0.8	5.0	15.2	13.4	14.7	0.36
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	499.0	7789	1.5	0.6	-5.5	9.3	10.6	12.7	0.29
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	927.7	5666	1.6	0.9	2.3	13.3	9.2	11.8	0.21
*	Navi Large & Midcap	36.3	303	2.1	0.5	2.2	11.0	11.5	12.9	0.31
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	29.2	5110	1.6	0.7	9.8	19.6	15.4	-	0.37
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2013.7	101822	1.3	0.7	1.5	18.0	17.7	16.3	0.58
*****	JM Flexicap	97.2	5069	1.6	0.6	-0.7	16.9	16.4	16.7	0.46
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.8	141447	1.1	0.5	-3.1	14.3	13.9	16.9	0.52
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.4	3374	1.7	0.5	0.5	15.4	13.3	14.8	0.37
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1601.5	18797	1.4	0.8	-3.1	15.0	13.5	13.4	0.39
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.1	5733	1.9	0.6	-0.6	10.3	9.1	13.9	0.23
*****	Union Flexi Cap	51.3	2289	1.7	0.8	0.2	12.8	11.4	13.3	0.31
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1889.9	26032	1.4	0.7	4.9	16.6	12.4	14.4	0.35
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	208.9	7257	1.5	0.9	-0.2	13.5	11.1	11.3	0.31
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	338.4	13010	1.5	0.5	-1.1	12.6	10.7	14.3	0.30
***	DSP Flexi Cap	103.0	11798	1.5	0.6	-0.3	13.9	10.9	14.4	0.28
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	226.3	5538	1.6	0.9	2.5	17.6	13.8	13.2	0.36
***	Kotak Flexicap	85.0	54801	1.4	0.6	-0.6	14.2	11.7	13.6	0.33
***	SBI Flexicap	106.9	22387	1.4	0.7	-1.4	9.8	9.2	12.0	0.25
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.5	3630	1.6	0.6	-4.1	12.4	10.1	-	0.28
**	Axis Flexi Cap	27.3	12625	1.5	0.6	1.8	13.7	9.9	-	0.24
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	58.0	12937	1.5	0.7	-7.1	18.0	11.5	12.5	0.30
**	Navi Flexi Cap	24.7	266	2.1	0.5	9.2	12.7	11.6	-	0.31
**	UTI Flexi Cap	308.6	22248	1.6	1.0	-5.6	8.1	6.0	11.7	0.11
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	102.3	997	1.9	1.0	6.1	13.0	10.5	10.5	0.26
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.8	129	2.1	0.7	-2.0	9.1	8.2	-	0.17
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	223.8	344	2.1	2.0	-1.3	13.0	10.3	9.9	0.27
-	Quant Flexi Cap	109.3	6994	1.6	0.6	12.3	19.1	15.9	19.8	0.44
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	289.7	3282	1.7	0.8	2.1	15.9	14.9	14.4	0.40
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	849.7	17676	1.4	0.8	6.8	18.9	16.2	15.0	0.51
-	Invesco India Multicap	128.4	4079	1.6	0.6	-3.1	15.2	12.3	13.8	0.30
-	Mah Manu Multi Cap	37.7	6643	1.6	0.4	6.3	18.8	16.0	-	0.43
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	302.3	53411	1.2	0.6	0.8	17.6	19.3	15.9	0.59
-	Quant Multi Cap	659.0	7664	1.5	0.6	4.3	13.1	12.8	17.7	0.31
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	381.4	2807	2.0	0.9	0.7	14.8	13.5	14.9	0.37
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	106.6	16849	1.4	0.4	4.3	22.8	19.0	18.7	0.53
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	204.9	97350	1.3	0.7	6.0	20.9	20.1	18.1	0.61
*****	Quant Mid Cap	220.1	8109	1.5	0.6	1.2	16.3	15.9	16.9	0.44
*****	Invesco India Midcap	193.6	12397	1.5	0.5	8.1	25.3	20.4	19.0	0.52
*****	Mah Manu Mid Cap	36.3	4866	1.6	0.4	9.4	22.5	18.4	-	0.51
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	93.9	36458	1.3	0.6	-8.9	17.7	21.6	16.3	0.54
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4471.2	47415	1.3	0.6	7.4	23.1	20.6	18.9	0.58
*****	Axis Midcap	119.0	32852	1.3	0.5	4.5	17.5	14.5	17.2	0.40
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	110.3	2461	1.7	0.5	9.8	19.9	16.0	15.9	0.46
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	338.5	7789	1.5	0.9	12.5	24.5	18.3	17.3	0.54
***	Kotak Midcap	144.0	64749	1.4	0.4	6.8	20.2	17.4	17.9	0.50
***	PGIM India Midcap	64.6	10822	1.8	0.6	-0.8	12.2	12.1	15.9	0.34
***	SBI Midcap	240.8	23417	1.4	0.7	1.7	13.1	15.1	14.3	0.44
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1466.0	13687	1.7	0.9	6.4	22.1	18.4	15.2	0.52
***	Tata Mid Cap	453.5	5732	1.6	0.6	5.6	18.4	16.0	16.4	0.46
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	831.6	6398	1.6	0.9	5.2	18.9	15.8	14.2	0.44
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2754.0	12231	1.5	0.8	-0.7	18.3	14.7	14.5	0.39
**	Taurus Mid Cap	117.9	125	2.1	1.7	-3.9	11.6	11.6	14.7	0.29
**	UTI Mid Cap	306.4	11871	1.7	0.9	0.7	14.3	13.4	14.2	0.36
**	DSP Midcap	153.2	19673	1.4	0.6	4.8	18.5	12.3	14.7	0.32
**	HSBC Midcap	455.6	14249	1.5	0.6	16.7	26.6	19.1	17.7	0.48
*	LIC MF Midcap	30.2	357	2.1	1.1	2.1	18.6	14.1	-	0.36
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	179.8	74604	1.1	0.5	5.5	18.8	20.5	21.3	0.52
*****	Quant Small Cap	280.4	31774	1.3	0.6	9.7	20.8	19.8	19.9	0.47

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	AXIS Small Cap	111.5	27840	1.4	0.5	4.0	16.2	17.1	18.7	0.48
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	53.6	2318	1.7	0.4	15.2	21.5	19.5	-	0.46
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	46.1	11717	1.5	0.4	9.5	23.7	20.4	-	0.49
***	DSP Small Cap	216.5	18358	1.4	0.6	8.9	19.1	18.4	16.8	0.46
***	HDFC Small Cap	137.9	38809	1.5	0.7	-0.6	14.5	16.5	17.8	0.42
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	89.6	8949	1.5	0.7	2.4	13.8	15.9	16.3	0.46
***	Kotak Small Cap	264.0	17806	1.7	0.6	0.0	13.3	13.6	16.9	0.35
***	Sundaram Small Cap	285.0	3681	1.9	0.9	10.4	19.1	17.6	15.1	0.44
***	Tata Small Cap	37.6	11645	1.5	0.4	-6.6	12.3	15.0	-	0.37
***	Union Small Cap	56.2	2094	1.8	0.8	16.6	19.3	17.8	16.7	0.42
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	176.4	13847	1.5	0.8	1.5	17.0	18.2	15.4	0.44
**	HSBC Small Cap	86.5	16877	1.4	0.6	4.0	16.9	18.6	18.8	0.43
**	SBI Small Cap	176.8	37395	1.3	0.6	2.4	13.3	14.2	18.4	0.38
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	94.3	5453	1.6	0.8	8.8	17.4	13.8	13.3	0.33
*	LIC MF Small Cap	33.3	695	2.0	0.9	10.2	18.2	18.4	-	0.43
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	39.6	13364	1.5	0.5	1.0	14.1	16.4	-	0.42
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	46.0	6156	1.6	0.4	4.2	17.7	17.4	-	0.46
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
*****	HSBC Value	113.6	14548	1.5	0.6	2.4	20.2	17.5	16.3	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Value	462.4	58954	1.2	0.8	-1.5	16.3	16.5	14.8	0.61
*****	Bandhan Value	147.2	9823	1.5	0.6	-0.5	13.2	14.3	15.5	0.41
*****	Nippon Ind Value	224.3	8821	1.5	0.9	-0.7	18.2	15.6	15.8	0.45
***	HDFC Value	768.7	7314	1.8	1.0	3.3	17.6	14.8	14.3	0.43
***	JM Value	94.7	805	2.0	1.0	-4.3	16.2	15.5	16.0	0.41
***	Templeton India Value	702.5	2087	1.8	0.8	-2.2	13.4	14.5	14.3	0.45
***	Union Value	28.8	375	2.1	1.1	3.0	15.8	14.0	-	0.42
***	UTI Value	164.7	9258	1.8	1.2	-2.4	15.3	12.5	13.6	0.38
**	Aditya Birla SL Value	133.0	6530	1.6	0.9	5.6	18.3	14.8	12.9	0.37
**	Tata Value	344.4	8346	1.5	0.7	-1.3	14.8	14.3	14.4	0.43
**	LIC MF Value	27.6	218	2.1	0.8	15.7	18.1	14.0	-	0.34
*	Quantum Value	118.3	1111	2.1	1.1	-6.2	12.4	10.4	11.0	0.32
-	Groww Value	27.2	68	2.4	1.0	0.0	15.3	11.8	10.8	0.34
-	Sundaram Value	213.1	1284	2.2	1.7	-3.4	9.7	10.1	11.0	0.28
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
*****	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	139.3	16156	1.4	0.6	-0.6	16.9	13.5	15.3	0.39
*****	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	404.2	13070	1.5	0.6	10.9	17.9	15.7	19.7	0.40
*****	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	436.7	30955	1.3	0.8	-0.6	18.7	16.6	14.8	0.51
*****	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	154.3	6767	1.6	0.6	1.3	12.2	12.5	15.0	0.35
*****	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	164.5	1380	1.8	0.8	2.6	15.6	13.1	16.2	0.33
*****	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	177.4	8472	1.5	0.6	0.3	12.9	11.2	14.8	0.32
*****	HDFC ELSS Tax saver	1361.7	15366	1.7	1.1	-3.8	16.0	16.0	13.8	0.53
*****	JM ELSS Tax Saver	49.9	223	2.1	0.9	3.5	16.6	14.6	16.0	0.39
*****	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	49.9	2574	1.4	0.6	2.1	14.7	12.1	16.9	0.34
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	98.1	882	2.0	0.9	3.1	16.3	12.2	12.9	0.33
*****	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1427.2	6039	1.6	0.9	-4.2	14.5	12.7	12.7	0.36
*****	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	932.0	13638	1.5	0.9	0.1	13.7	12.1	13.0	0.35
*****	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	114.9	6020	1.9	0.7	-0.7	12.7	12.0	14.2	0.33
*****	Mahindra ELSS Tax Saver	27.2	867	2.0	0.7	-5.3	9.8	10.2	-	0.28
*****	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	55.5	4663	1.6	0.6	5.9	22.4	17.6	17.1	0.42
*****	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	117.6	208	2.1	0.9	-6.1	12.3	10.4	11.1	0.32
*****	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	496.9	1263	2.2	1.6	-2.4	11.6	11.2	13.5	0.32
*****	Tata ELSS	46.0	4516	1.6	0.7	3.5	14.6	13.1	13.9	0.37
*****	Union ELSS Tax Saver	64.7	835	2.0	1.2	0.5	12.5	11.9	13.0	0.34
**	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	113.2	436	2.1	0.7	2.0	14.1	12.2	12.6	0.34
**	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	139.3	3985	1.6	1.0	3.0	17.4	13.7	13.8	0.36
**	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	122.0	2536	1.7	0.8	-3.8	13.2	14.0	13.2	0.44
**	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	131.2	14700	1.5	0.9	2.2	15.8	14.4	11.4	0.41
**	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	34.0	689	2.4	0.9	-3.1	9.1	10.2	12.8	0.27
**	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	200.8	3400	2.0	1.1	-3.7	10.6	9.2	12.0	0.23
**	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	61.2	14249	1.5	0.8	1.1	13.5	8.8	10.8	0.22
**	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	95.3	31023	1.3	0.7	-1.6	10.9	7.4	12.0	0.14
**	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	147.1	978	1.9	0.9	-4.4	10.8	10.3	12.1	0.27
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.9	50	2.4	0.9	-5.5	10.5	8.8	-	0.22
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.7	46	2.1	0.6	-1.7	8.9	8.2	-	0.17
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	176.4	70	2.1	1.5	-5.8	11.8	10.8	12.8	0.32
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	132.9	19517	1.4	0.5	-2.1	16.8	13.7	15.7	0.38
-	Kotak Contra	151.7	5162	1.9	0.6	1.4	17.4	14.9	16.0	0.44
-	SBI Contra	372.9	47263	1.3	0.6	-2.9	14.3	16.7	15.6	0.57
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	53.3	6477	1.6	0.5	1.8	19.1	18.7	15.8	0.65
*****	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	135.8	2317	1.7	1.0	-1.7	13.9	13.2	15.1	0.51
***	LIC MF Dividend Yield	32.1	686	2.1	0.7	3.1	20.3	15.9	-	0.44
***	UTI Dividend Yield	175.8	3697	1.9	1.4	-0.3	16.8	12.9	14.1	0.41
**	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	447.3	1459	1.8	1.1	-0.1	15.6	14.0	13.1	0.45
*	Sundaram Dividend Yield	130.3	830	2.3	1.1	-3.3	12.0	10.7	14.2	0.35
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Consumption	186.7	2368	1.7	0.6	-6.4	11.0	13.4	12.8	0.37
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	29.7	1383	1.8	0.6	-4.9	10.2	11.0	-	0.28
*****	Canara Robeco Consumption	104.4	1883	1.8	0.7	-5.4	11.1	12.0	15.1	0.31
*****	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	203.2	5843	1.6	0.7	-5.9	10.1	10.9	13.8	0.28
***	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	90.1	4389	1.6	0.4	-2.2	11.1	13.0	15.2	0.33
***	SBI Consumption Opport	284.6	2806	0.8	0.3	-8.3	8.1	12.9	13.8	0.34
***	Tata India Consumer	45.2	2583	1.7	0.6	3.1	14.6	14.0	16.2	0.37
**	Sundaram Consumption	90.1	1388	2.1	1.3	-8.0	10.5	11.0	11.7	0.28
**	UTI India Consumer	56.1	664	2.6	1.8	-2.8	10.7	10.0	11.2	0.24
*	Mahindra Consumption	21.4	492	2.1	0.6	-4.2	9.9	10.4	-	0.27
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
*****	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	108.7	1590	2.1	0.8	3.1	15.1	14.0	14.4	0.35
*****	Invesco India Fin Serv	148.0	1701	1.5	0.7	6.4	19.3	15.0	15.7	0.37
*****	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	649.5	7442	1.8	0.8	1.6	14.5	14.2	14.1	0.36
***	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	63.6	3466	1.7	0.9	3.5	13.3	11.8	13.1	0.26
***	ICICI Pru Banking & Financial Serv	132.9	10643	1.5	0.9	-1.5	11.7	10.5	13.1	0.24
***	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	44.4	10375	1.5	0.7	3.7	17.6	13.1	15.7	0.31
***	Tata Banking & Fin Serv	44.0	3036	1.7	0.5	0.4	13.5	12.1	14.5	0.29
**	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	48.8	395	2.1	0.7	0.9	14.5	11.7	12.3	0.27
**	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	197.0	1340	2.1	1.1	2.5	14.2	12.1	11.4	0.28
*	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	21.5	256	2.1	1.0	1.6	8.8	10.2	9.5	0.23
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	54.1	11	2.1	1.4	-0.6	10.6	10.6	12.9	0.24
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
*****	SBI Technology Opport	178.7	4228	1.6	0.8	-18.7	7.5	7.3	14.5	0.22
*****	ICICI Pru Technology	164.9	13358	1.5	0.9	-19.9	6.8	5.2	14.7	0.15
***	Franklin Ind Technology	431.4	1645	1.7	0.9	-17.2	10.6	7.1	14.0	0.20
**	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	140.9	3817	1.6	0.8	-19.9	4.4	4.5	14.3	0.13
*	Tata Digital India	38.3	9660	1.5	0.5	-22.0	5.4	4.9	14.0	0.14
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru P.H.D	42.6	6454	1.6	0.9	9.1	26.4	16.2	-	0.53
*****	DSP Healthcare	42.6	3309	1.7	0.5	11.4	22.3	14.7	-	0.45
***	Mirae Asset Healthcare	43.0	3091	1.7	0.4	14.1	24.0	14.4	-	0.45
***	Nippon Ind Pharma	550.8	8636	1.5	0.8	7.8	21.5	12.8	15.6	0.40
***	SBI Healthcare Opport	484.1	4566	1.6	0.8	14.6	24.4	16.5	13.9	0.55
**	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	32.0	1387	1.8	0.7	7.7	21.7	13.7	13.4	0.43
-	UTI Healthcare	320.8	1217	2.2	1.2	13.7	26.0	14.8	14.0	0.45
-	LIC MF Healthcare	31.4	89	2.1	1.0	10.0	22.0	10.9	-	0.31
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
*****	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	41.6	1554	1.8	0.6	8.8	19.4	15.5	-	0.43
*****	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	405.1	50033	1.2	0.8	3.4	16.6	16.7	15.7	0.71
*****	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	470.3	2128	1.8	0.6	11.2	15.2	13.6	16.0	0.44
*****	Baroda BNP Pari Aggressive Hybrid	27.9	1324	1.9	0.5	-0.4	11.9	9.9	-	0.32
*****	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	64.2	3667	1.6	0.4	0.8	13.9	13.1	12.7	0.51
*****	JM Aggressive Hybrid	115.9	692	2.0	0.7	-5.1	14.5	12.8	11.9	0.40
*****	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	64.5	8670	1.8	0.5	3.7	13.8	12.0	12.9	0.42
*****	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	404.5	6473	1.5	1.0	-0.3	13.1	12.3	12.0	0.46
***	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	27.3	2021	1.8	0.5	6.6	14.6	11.7	-	0.39
***	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	364.1	10953	1.5	0.5	0.6	11.6	9.9	12.4	0.37

bl rating

Scheme Name

Latest NAV
(₹)

Latest Corpus
(₹ Cr.)

Expense Ratio (%)

Trailing Returns (%)

AA & Below

1 Month
*Ann

3 Month
*Ann

6 Month
*Ann

1 Year
CAGR

Regular

Direct

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid

2129.5

748

0.3

0.2

6.8

6.8

6.3

6.0

-

- Aditya Birla SL Liquid

446.7

47520

0.3

0.2

7.7

7.3

6.6

6.3

-

- Axis Liquid

3088.6

56168

0.2

0.1

7.6

7.4

6.7

6.3

-

- Bandhan Liquid

3346.5

17286

0.2

0.1

7.4

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- Bank of India Liquid

3194.1

1720

0.1

0.1

7.5

7.2

6.6

6.3

-

- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid

3185.5

11380

0.2

0.1

7.3

7.1

6.5

6.2

0.20

- Canara Robeco Liquid

3336.6

7521

0.1

0.1

7.0

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- DSP Liquidity

3959.1

19019

0.2

0.1

7.7

7.3

6.6

6.3

-

- Edelweiss Liquid

3546.9

15222

0.2

0.1

7.5

7.4

6.6

6.3

-

- Groww Liquid

2681.0

262

0.2

0.1

7.3

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- HDFC Liquid

5438.8

67998

0.3

0.2

7.4

7.2

6.6

6.2

-

- HSBC Liquid

2763.7

16117

0.2

0.1

7.6

7.3

6.6

6.2

-

- ICICI Pru Liquid

410.2

58096

0.3

0.2

7.5

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- Invesco India Liquid

3810.9

14989

0.2

0.1

7.6

7.3

6.6

6.3

-

- ITI Liquid

1440.7

49

0.2

0.1

6.3

6.8

6.1

6.0

-

- JM Liquid

75.6

2147

0.2

0.1

7.3

7.1

6.4

6.1

-

- Kotak Liquid

5601.5

40018

0.3

0.2

7.6

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- LIC MF Liquid

5010.5

16015

0.2

0.1

7.5

7.3

6.6

6.2

-

- Mahi Manu Liquid

1803.7

1088

0.2

0.1

7.5

7.1

6.5

6.2

-

- Mirae Asset Liquid

2905.0

11182

0.2

0.1

7.3

7.0

6.4

6.2

0.40

- Motilal Oswal Liquid

14.6

937

0.4

0.2

7.1

6.4

6.0

5.8

-

- Navi Liquid

30.0

78

0.2

0.2

6.6

6.1

5.8

5.7

-

- Nippon Ind Liquid

6765.2

31752

0.3

0.2

7.7

7.3

6.6

6.2

-

- Parag Parikh Liquid

1536.8

5524

0.2

0.1

7.3

7.2

6.5

6.2

-

- PGIM India Liquid

361.0

612

0.2

0.1

7.6

7.4

6.6

6.3

-

- Quantum Liquid

43.6

1247

0.5

0.3

6.8

5.9

5.8

5.7

-

- Quantum Liquid

37.0

530

0.3

0.2

6.6

6.1

5.8

5.7

-

- SBI Liquid

4331.7

79363

0.3

0.2

7.4

7.3

6.6

6.2

-

- Sundaram Liquid

2442.4

7657

0.4

0.1

7.4

7.2

6.4

6.1

-

- Tata Liquid

4365.5

30449

0.3

0.2

7.3

7.1

6.5

6.2

-

- Union Liquid

2667.8

8782

0.2

0.1

7.4

7.2

6.6

6.3

-

- UTI Liquid

454.9

33248

0.3

0.2

7.5

7.3

6.6

6.3

-

- WhiteOak Capital Liquid

1489.0

608

0.3

0.2

7.4

7.0

6.4

6.1

-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1461.5	9420	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
-	Axis Overnight	1437.8	11863	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1442.4	813	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1382.7	143	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1425.4	1255	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1405.6	419	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	DSP Overnight	1451.7	3002	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1404.9	192	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1417.3	1120	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
-	Groww Overnight	1395.2	212	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
-	HDFC Overnight	3998.9	10587	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1414.5	4681	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1459.9	13075	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1372.4	289	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	ITI Overnight	1370.0	14	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
-	JM Overnight	1374.9	310	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1444.8	7846	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1401.5	1212	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1401.2	84	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1389.7	2025	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	145.5	7463	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1399.0	63	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	SBI Overnight	4372.8	27025	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1437.7	1483	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
-	Tata Overnight	1427.5	3895	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Union Overnight	1424.9	705	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
-	UTI Overnight	3689.9	4259	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.1	26280	0.9	0.3	8.7	5.9	5.9	5.9	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.8	9781	0.9	0.3	8.6	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	34.3	8189	0.9	0.3	8.3	5.6	5.7	5.7	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	48	0.9	0.4	6.1	5.2	5.4	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.0	1272	0.9	0.3	8.0	5.5	5.5	5.7	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.8	6382	0.9	0.3	8.7	5.8	5.9	5.8	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.5	14862	0.9	0.3	8.3	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.4	25085	0.9	0.4	8.6	6.0	6.1	6.0	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	20.1	2667	0.7	0.2	8.6	5.8	6.1	6.0	-
-	ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.3	32260	0.8	0.3	8.7	5.9	6.0	6.0	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.8	28062	0.9	0.3	8.0	5.9	6.0	6.1	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.7	88	0.8	0.2	4.9	4.3	5.8	5.8	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.4	369	0.9	0.4	7.0	5.2	5.6	5.7	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.7	72079	1.0	0.4	8.3	5.9	6.1	6.0	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.6	239	0.8	0.3	8.0	5.8	6.1	5.9	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.0	121	1.0	0.3	6.7	5.0	5.4	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.8	3643	0.8	0.1	7.6	5.3	5.8	5.8	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.1	16294	0.9	0.3	8.7	5.9	6.0	5.9	0.80
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.4	92	1.0	0.4	7.2	5.8	6.0	5.6	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.8	43266	0.8	0.4	8.0	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.3	468	1.0	0.2	7.6	6.0	6.2	5.9	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.2	22760	0.9	0.3	8.4	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.8	242	0.9	0.3	8.1	5.6	5.9	5.8	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	37.1	10991	1.0	0.4	8.8	5.9	6.0	6.1	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	582.8	19611	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.2	7.3	6.4	10.92
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1638.4	775	0.4	0.2	6.2	7.0	7.1	6.3	-
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4274.4	10938	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.8	6.6	19.13
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.2	4440	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.4	16002	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	9.63
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1391.4	1715	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.3	5.98
*****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4485.8	3997	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	6.4	8.59
*****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.6	6168	1.1	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.7	10.59
*****	DSP Ultra Short	3602.9	4711	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.6	5.8	6.37
*****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.1	16658	0.7	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	5.31
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1438.6	3525	0.3	0.1	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
*****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2859.1	1197	0.7	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	5.9	4.42
*****	Kotak Savings	45.4	16186	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.0	5.79
*****	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1459.3	213	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.69
*****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6339.9	11861	0.5	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	8.98
*****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1438.3	560	1.0	0.5	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
*****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3345.8	140	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.7	7.86
*****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1396.6	371	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.6	1.46
*****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.0	175	0.9	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.86
*****	Tata Ultra Short Term	15.0	5454	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.6	5.7	10.03
*****	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4017.0	528	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.6	-
*****	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.3	380	1.0	0.2	5.1	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
*****	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2822.7	2331	1.4	0.2	5.1	5.9	6.0	5.2	1.33
DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										

DEBT - LONG DURATION FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Savings	578.8	25885	0.5	0.4	6.3	7.3	7.5	6.5	7.01
*****	UTI Low Duration	3769.9	3151	0.4	0.3	6.1	7.2	7.2	7.4	6.97
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3285.2	5803	0.6	0.3	6.1	7.1	7.1	6.3	8.24
*****	DSP Low Duration	21.0	4773	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	61.1	20218	1.1	0.5	5.7	6.8	6.9	6.1	14.47
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.4	1012	0.8	0.3	6.0	7.6	7.5	6.3	10.14
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	693.0	13011	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.9	9.81

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★★★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.9	5811	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.9	6.9	6.0	-
★★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	44.7	1099	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	4008.7	1849	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.9	7.0	6.0	5.23
★★★★★	JM Low Duration	39.2	227	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.8	5.9	3.29
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3965.7	9359	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.9	6.9	6.0	8.64
★★★★★	SBI Low Duration	3689.0	13167	0.8	0.4	5.5	6.7	6.7	5.9	4.01
★★★★★	Star Treasury Advantage	4169.2	2755	0.5	0.2	5.9	7.0	7.0	6.1	3.80
★★★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3532.2	13370	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.7	6.7	5.9	11.98
★★★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1729.2	550	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.7	5.8	13.80
★★★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2390.6	2176	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.9	5.27
★★★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3645.6	364	1.1	0.4	5.3	6.5	6.6	5.8	2.66
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.4	293	0.9	0.2	5.6	6.6	6.6	5.7	1.71
★★★★★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.9	1608	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.7	5.8	6.40

Big Tech turns start-up investors for early access to innovation, talent, IP

BALANCE. Tech giants picking minority stakes, rather than acquiring, for fast growth on tight budgets

**Sanjana B
Jyoti Banthia**
Bengaluru

Meta’s investment in fintech unicorn Cred reinforces a growing trend among global technology companies that are increasingly choosing strategic investments over outright acquisitions to strengthen their presence in India’s fast-growing start-up ecosystem.

The deal follows a string of investments by companies including Google, Microsoft, Amazon and HCLTech across sectors such as artificial intelligence (AI), fintech, enterprise software and space-tech.

Analysts said that minority investments allow technology giants to gain early access to innovation, talent and intellectual property while avoiding the cost, complexity and regulatory hurdles associated with acquisitions.

“Start-ups can play a critical role



INVESTMENT MOTIVES. The objectives of strategic investors also differ from those of traditional venture capital firms

in the execution of an innovation strategy due to their unmatched agility,” said Anushree Verma, Senior Director Analyst at Gartner.

“Securing access to critical technologies and human resource has become a top priority for CIOs. They have to balance the speed of innovation with organisational growth while burdened with tight budgets,” she added.

Rather than integrating start-ups into their organisations, large technology firms are increasingly

using minority stakes to build long-term partnerships and expand their product ecosystems.

“Tech giants invest rather than acquire to retain flexibility while accelerating ecosystem growth,” said Biswajeet Mahapatra, Principal Analyst at Forrester. “These investments expand their platforms by bringing in complementary capabilities, creating a broader network of services that strengthens long-term customer lock-in and innovation velocity.”

Strategic investments enable technology companies to tap external innovation while retaining the option to deepen partnerships or pursue acquisitions later.

The objectives of strategic investors also differ from those of traditional venture capital firms.

“Traditional VC firms track from a revenue perspective whereas these investors partner as collaborators,” Verma said.

Analysts say strategic backing often boosts start-up valuations by signalling credibility and providing access to global distribution networks and enterprise customers. At the same time, these partnerships can present challenges.

Mahapatra noted that startups may face pressure to align their product roadmaps with the priorities of a strategic investor, potentially restricting partnerships with competing platforms. Such alignment, while beneficial commercially, could reduce strategic flexibility over time.

Ashok Vaswani to step down as MD/CEO of Kotak Bank in Dec

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Ashok Vaswani on Saturday informed the Kotak Mahindra Bank board that he does not wish to seek re-appointment as Managing Director and CEO upon completion of his current term on December 31, 2026. The board has initiated the process of finding a new chief.

Vaswani, who took over the reins from Dipak Gupta (MD and CEO from September to December 2023) on January 01, 2024, cited “personal reasons” for not seeking a re-appointment.

“The board, at its meeting held today... has initiated the process for the appointment of a new Managing Director and CEO. The process will be completed within applicable regulatory timelines,” the private sector bank said in a regulatory filing.



daCunha/AB/1113

Cooperative Bharat Taxi will end exploitation of drivers, users: Amit Shah

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad



Union Home Minister
Amit Shah

Accusing private ride-hailing companies of exploiting both drivers and passengers, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Saturday said the cooperative Bharat Taxi platform was created to end practices such as high commission deduction, delayed payments and arbitrary cancellation of drivers’ registrations.

Without naming ride-hailing companies, Shah said the rapid growth of app-based taxi services had come at the cost of drivers, who were forced to part with a significant share of their earnings while having little say in how platforms operated.

MANY COMPLAINTS

“Different kinds of complaints used to come. At some places, commissions used to be cut from driver’s profit, for many days profits and rents never used to reach the drivers, registrations used to be cancelled on customer complaints without hearing the driver’s side of the story. Thus, we thought of introducing a service that will be based on the cooperative model which will also end all the exploitation,” Shah said while formally launching the Bharat Taxi services in 14 cities of Gujarat including Ahmedabad.

Shah also suggested that the launch of Bharat Taxi has already begun influencing pricing in the ride-hailing market. He claimed that incumbent platforms had started lowering fares in cities where Bharat Taxi has started operations. “These tactics can work anywhere in the world, but not in India,” Shah said, arguing that unlike venture-backed platforms, a drivers owned cooperative would not be forced to retreat because of

DRIVER OWNER

According to Shah, the cooperative model seeks to fundamentally alter that equation by making drivers stakeholders rather than mere service providers. Every driver joining Bharat Taxi becomes a shareholder of the cooperative by buying shares worth ₹100, giving rise to its tagline, ‘*Saarthi Hi Maalik*’ (the driver is the owner). Besides retaining their earnings through a zero-commission model, drivers are promised access to insurance, loans, pensions and government social security schemes.

The platform, registered under the Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, has been promoted by Sahkar Taxi Cooperative Ltd with support from eight of India’s largest cooperative institutions including GCMMF (Amul), IFFCO, KRIBHCO, NDDB, NAFED, NABARD, NCDC and NCEL.

BIG EXPANSION

Bharat Taxi unveiled an aggressive expansion roadmap. Jayen Mehta, chairman of Sahkar Taxi Cooperative Limited, said the platform has onboarded 7 lakh drivers and nearly 40 lakh customers since its launch in February. Over the next year, Bharat Taxi plans to expand to 30 State capitals and 125 cities, while Shah set an even more ambitious target of reaching over 500 cities in three years.

Think Gas looks to add 4-5 lakh piped natural gas consumers by Dec

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Think Gas is targeting to add 4-5 lakh piped natural gas (PNG) consumers by December as the country’s second largest city gas distribution (CGD) firm aims to tap the momentum created by the government to migrate liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) consumers to piped gas. “Four-five lakh households is what we ideally would love to have by December (2026), and we are working towards that. Hopefully we will be achieving that number, and the ecosystem will help us,” Vinukumar S Balakrishnan, Chief Marketing and Commercial Officer at Think Gas, told *businessline*.

Apart from what has been identified by the PNGRB (Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board), Think Gas is also strategising on initiatives to explore avenues to expand its network, he added.

“PNGRB gave us a number, close to four lakh, which we had to add. We are confident that we’ll be able to add those numbers. The idea being that now this is a very innovative approach they have taken in the sense that they are trying to enable us in terms of how we can maximise the infrastructure,” Balakrishnan noted.

The year 2026 marks a significant turning point for the

CGD sector, which began with PNGRB’s PNG National Drive 2.0 to add more consumers to Domestic PNG (D-PNG).

WEST ASIA EFFECT

The effort got a major push with the current West Asian conflict as the government in a bid to conserve LPG initiated policy measures to accelerate adoption of D-PNG.

The results are encouraging. For instance, around 10.02 lakh PNG connections have been gasified and infrastructure created for additional 3.22 lakh connections, since March 2026. Besides, another 9.94 lakh customers have been registered for new connections.

Balakrishnan agrees that the government push amidst the West Asian conflict helped migrate higher LOG consumers to PNG.

“What was challenging for the industry is the visibility in trying to understand what will be happening two weeks or four down the line and especially in the early stages of the crisis in March and that was really the challenge,” he noted.

On India adding more than a million PNG connections since March, he said the government actually utilised this situation very efficiently.

Going ahead, he expresses optimism on the drive to add more PNG consumers.

Op Sindoor martyrs: No misleading claims by Rajnath Singh in House, says Defence Ministry

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Defence on Saturday issued a statement, clarifying that Defence Minister Rajnath Singh’s address on the floor of Parliament on July 28, 2025, was “selectively quoted” to “falsely imply” that Singh claimed that no Indian soldier lost his life during Operation Sindoor.

“These are deliberately misleading and factually incorrect,” the Ministry insisted.

This is in response to some reports which stated that while the government has released the names of six martyrs of Operation Sindoor, Rajnath Singh, during his earlier speech in Parliament, stated that India

did not lose any personnel during the four day conflict with Pakistan.

FULL CONTEXT

Those who have sought to construct a controversy out of Minister’s parliamentary address have done so by deliberately ignoring the full context of his remarks, a MoD’s statement read.

It must be recalled that at the time of the Rajnath Singh’s address, a particularly persistent and dominant narrative had taken hold, both in certain sections of the media and on social media, which claimed that Indian pilots had been lost during Operation Sindoor, the Ministry noted.

“This narrative was entirely false, yet it was being amplified aggressively

with the clear intent of diminishing the success of the operation and demoralising public sentiment,” the MoD stated.

It was in direct reference to this specific and mischievous narrative that the Defence Minister made the statement in question.

“His remarks were, therefore, a targeted and contextually specific response to a falsehood that was gaining dangerous traction at that moment,” the Ministry observed.

Recalling his statement, the MoD stated that in its entirety, it was “a proud and accurate account of the remarkable success” of Operation Sindoor, an operation in which the Indian defence forces demonstrated unmatched precision, resolve, and military professionalism.

MDMK withdraws from DMK-led alliance to decide on future ties at ‘appropriate time’

Asian News International
Chennai

The Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) on Saturday announced its withdrawal from the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance, and said the party would decide on its future electoral alliance at an appropriate time. The decision was taken through a resolution passed at the party’s General Council meeting.

According to the resolution, the MDMK said it had remained a part of the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance for the past nine years out of ideological commitment to prevent “communal political forces” from gaining ground in Tamil Nadu and to

uphold the principles of the Dravidian movement.

ELECTION DEVELOPMENTS

The resolution stated that during the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, there were attempts within the alliance to weaken the MDMK’s independent political identity despite its 32-year political journey.

The MDMK also referred to remarks made by its General Secretary, Vaiko, before the election results, stating that he had predicted a significant verdict from the people of Tamil Nadu. Referring to the post-election political developments, the party alleged that the political negotiations that followed were contrary to

the people’s mandate. “It is an open secret that arrangements were made to install the AIADMK, which had won only 47 Assembly seats, by forging an alliance with Hindutva communal forces.

The party said its office-bearers and workers had expressed the view that the MDMK should no longer remain in the DMK-led alliance. “Therefore, this General Council resolves that the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam shall withdraw from the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance,” the resolution said. The General Council further resolved that the party would take an appropriate decision on future electoral alliances at the time of elections.

Aarogya Setu 2.0 tops slew of digital initiatives coming on Monday for easy health-care access

Our Bureau
Mumbai

A series of digital initiatives in the health sector, including the Aarogya Setu 2.0 — a personal health record application (PHR) for citizens — will be unveiled on Monday, June 29, by Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare JP Nadda.

The initiatives being launched include “citizen-facing applications, provider-focused solutions, interoperability frameworks, registries and data standards,” according to the Health Ministry.

ONE PLATFORM ACCESS

The revamped Aarogya Setu 2.0 app is built on the Covid experience and provides a gateway to multiple digital health services through a single platform, the Ministry said. “The application enables creation and management of ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account), access to and sharing of digital health records, consent-

based health information exchange, AI-powered health insights and smart health reports, wearable device integration, OPD registration through Scan & Register, hospital payments through Scan & Pay, medication reminders and family health management,” it said.

The app would also help locate nearby healthcare facilities and doctors, ambulance services, blood banks with blood unit availability, and Jan Aushadhi Kendras. The application also provides access to PM-JAY services, including search for PM-JAY empanelled hospitals, access to AB PM-JAY (Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana) wallet, etc., the note added.

HEALTH INSURANCE

The enhanced Ayushman app will also serve as a one-stop digital platform for beneficiaries of AB PM-JAY health insurance scheme.

Also being launched is Ayushman Sarathi, a WhatsApp chatbot for beneficiaries of Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, to



deliver PM-JAY services through a conversational interface.

CLAIMS PROCESSING

The Ministry also pointed to the National Health Claims Exchange (NHCE), a digital public infrastructure for health claims processing, that would enable standardised exchange of health claims information between providers and payers across public and private health insurance programmes — reducing administrative burden and facilitating faster and more efficient claims

processing, it said.

A Unified Health Interface (UHI) will enable digital applications to connect citizens with healthcare service providers through a common framework, facilitating easier discovery and access to healthcare services.

The e-Sushrut Clinic will be unveiled “as a plug-and-play clinic management solution that enables healthcare providers to digitise clinical workflows, maintain electronic health records and seamlessly integrate with the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission ecosystem,” it added.

A ‘Drug Registry’ will also be launched to standardise medicine-related information across the healthcare ecosystem, it said. “By enabling uniform coding of medicines across digital health applications, the registry will strengthen prescribing, dispensing and healthcare data exchange,” it said.

UNIFORM STANDARDS

Recognising that interoper-

ability is built upon common standards and shared vocabularies, the government will launch the Common LOINC Codes for India (CLCI), a nationally curated subset of international laboratory standards tailored for Indian healthcare needs, developed by NRCeS, the Ministry said.

“By enabling standardised representation of laboratory observations and diagnostic information, CLCI will support seamless exchange of laboratory data across hospitals, laboratories and digital health platforms, while improving consistency, data quality and clinical decision-making,” it added.

STANDARDISED CODE

The Bharat Health Terminology Service, also developed by NRCeS, will provide access to standardised healthcare terminologies, code systems and value sets to support semantic interoperability across digital health systems by enabling consistent interpretation and exchange of health information, it said.

AP CM disburses ₹300 crore to Veligonda Irrigation Project displaced



Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu during his visit to inspect the Veligonda project feeder canal at Gantavani Palle and handover compensation cheques to the displaced

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Saturday disbursed ₹300 crore as part of the Resettlement and Rehabilitation (R&R) programme under the Veligonda Irrigation Project in Prakasam district.

Speaking on the occasion, the Chief Minister said the NDA government in the State was spending ₹900 crore as part of the R&R for those who were displaced by the project and ₹3,000 crore for the construction of the project while the Government of India had given ₹980 crore.

“There is a painful story behind 7,222 who got displaced due to the project and lost land in the native villages. The previous YSRCP government had only rehab-

ilitated 96 people and foisted false cases on those who requested compensation and rehabilitation,” Naidu said.

According to a release, the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) government had completed most of the project works between 2014-19 when it was in power and the previous government had ‘hurdled’ announced dedication of the project without undertaking any works to complete the project or the R&R programme.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD, the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.